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VISIT CANCELLED

Centre denies nod for
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'SALUTARY SCHEME'

SC lauds
scrapped
MGNREGA
scheme

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MULTILINGUAL STAR

Veteran actor Sowcar
Janaki dies at 94

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SEASON OF UNCERTAINTY

A dry spell along
the Cauvery river

Poor rainfall, pressure
on reservoir storage
cloud the crop season

GROUND ZERO » PAGE 9



MEDAL ASSURED

Gayatri and Treesa
enter the semifinal

SPORT » PAGE 15



CBI seeks sanction for prosecution against Nagendra

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a development expected to turn up the heat on the Congress, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) is learnt to have recently sought sanction for prosecution from Governor Thaaawarchand Gehlot against Planning and Statistics Minister B. Nagendra, even as the Opposition BJP and JD(S) continued to disrupt legislature proceedings for the fifth consecutive day on Friday seeking ouster of the Minister.

The Opposition has been at loggerheads with the government demanding that Mr. Nagendra, who is facing a slew of cases in connection with the ₹89.63 crore embezzlement in Karnataka Maharshi Valmiki ST Development Corporation, be dropped from the Cabinet. The money was allegedly transferred

Protest against Kashappanavar

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

BJP and JD(S) members protested in the Council, demanding legal action against Minister Vijayananda S. Kashappanavar for his allegedly derogatory remarks about Dalits.

As Mr. Kashappanavar entered the House, BJP and JD(S) members raised slogans against him. Leader of Opposition Chalavadi Narayanaswamy said that Mr. Kashappanavar had made derogatory remarks about Dalits while criticising the Prime Minister.

to multiple accounts, and so far, about ₹79 crore has been recovered.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

CJP team on school inspection attacked

Activists attempted to inspect a govt. school in a Rajasthan village where classes are being held in a cattle enclosure; CJP blames BJP involvement

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

A team of Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) activists was allegedly assaulted and chased out of Rampura-Kanwarapura village near Jaipur on Friday, when it attempted to inspect a government school as part of the organisation's 'School Thik Karo' campaign. The vehicles of team members were damaged, and women supporters were allegedly roughed up.

The team, led by party co-convenor Ashutosh Ranka, travelled to the village in the Bagru Assembly constituency to inspect the Government Primary School. However, some villagers had barricaded the road and checked the vehicles entering the area.



CJP workers being confronted during their 'School Thik Karo' campaign at Bagru village in Jaipur, Rajasthan, on Friday. PTI

When the team of about 40 CJP workers arrived, some people asked them to leave. During a scuffle that followed, the team members were allegedly manhandled and driven out with stone-pelting.

Mr. Ranka said one volunteer had suffered a fractured arm. He alleged that those involved in the attack had been brought in by the

ruling BJP. The school building had earlier been declared unsafe and was closed. Currently, classes are being held in a cattle enclosure. The villagers, however, claimed that the funds for school repair work had already been sanctioned.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

After Cong. stir, Delhi Police register FIR over pellet gun use

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Following a seven-hour dharna (sit-in) by the Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, outside the office of New Delhi's Deputy Commissioner of Police, police registered an FIR against the use of pellet guns on protesters during the July 20 march to Parliament. Mr. Gandhi held the dharna after Sahil Lochab, a 19-year-old who lost vision in one eye after being hit by pellets during the protest, said the police had refused to register an FIR on his complaint.

The Congress leader, accompanied by his sister and Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other Congress leaders, ended the sit-in after the police relented. The FIR was registered under Sections 118(1) (voluntarily causing hurt using dangerous weapons) and 125 of the Bharatiya



Rahul Gandhi and Sahil Lochav at the Parliament Street Police Station. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Nyaya Sanhita.

Mr. Lochab said he had written a seven-page complaint as soon as he was discharged from the hospital and went to various police stations. "I have been trying to get an FIR registered first at Connaught Place, then at Mandir Marg, Sansad Marg and even the Crime Branch but to no avail," he said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

NEARBY



User Development Fees reduced at KIA from Sept. 1

BENGALURU
The Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India announced revised User Development Fees for KIA, which cuts down the fee to ₹300 for departing domestic passengers. » PAGE 3

Cabinet again seeks Sahukar's suspension

BENGALURU
The Cabinet is learnt to have decided to again recommend the suspension of KPSC chairman Shivashankarappa S. Sahukar, who has been accused of favouring his two daughters for selection as Industrial Extension Officers. » PAGE 6

PROPERTYPLUS » PAGE 4

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Shri D.K. Shivakumar
Hon'ble Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka



Government of Karnataka



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Hon'ble Minister for Greater Bengaluru Development



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Government of Karnataka

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A BG-BGE

A line of yellow and green auto-rickshaws is parked along the side of a road. A person in a red shirt is walking past them. The background shows lush green trees and a 'P' parking sign.

Central corporation rolls out GPS tracking for 138 garbage tippers

User Development Fee reduced at KIA, but arriving passengers should also pay

Cabinet clears AI surveillance cameras and portable signal jammers for prisons



Dr. B. K. Chakrabarti

years now, to no relief. “We are unable to make emergency calls or even place online orders because OTPs do not arrive on time. The jammers appear to be blocking signals outside the prison rather than being confined to the prison premises,” said Mohan Kumar, a resident and employee of a private firm.

According to the residents, mobile connectivity becomes particularly unreliable in the areas surrounding the prison, affecting phone calls, OTP-based transactions, Wi-Fi connectivity and other internet-dependent services.

BJP MP C.N. Manjunath on July 21 wrote to the Union Communications Minister Jyotiraditya M. Scindia and sought his intervention over the disruption of mobile and internet services around the prison.

Weaver found dead

Garbage spot cleared near government school in J.C. Nagar

A photograph showing two men in blue uniforms walking past a large pile of garbage and debris. The trash includes several large green and white bags, some with 'AFS' and 'CHERPAK' printed on them, and various other bags and debris. The scene is outdoors, with a stone wall in the background.

Absconding rowdy-sheeter arrested

₹9 cr. unaccounted cash found in car; I-T officials launch probe

ty Police Station. Subsequently, they were handed over to the I-T officials.

During a search of the car, the officials found ₹9 crore in cash, for which the persons in the car didn't have any record. The department detained one of the occupants of the car, identified as Sachin, 42, of Sindhu Jewellers in Tamil Nadu. Following the seizure, the officials searched the residence of some persons in Tamil Nadu and seized another ₹1.3 crore in cash. The department is conducting inquiries into the source and intended destination of the cash, the police said.

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Instagram home effect

How social media is making Indian homeowners rethink when, why and how they renovate their spaces

COVER

Amit Kumar Agarwal

For decades, home renovation was largely triggered by necessity: a new home, a growing family, ageing furniture, a leaking kitchen or a functional problem that needed fixing.

Today, there is another trigger: comparison.

You see a beautifully styled living room on Instagram, save an earthy kitchen on Pinterest, watch a home makeover on YouTube or see a celebrity's walk-in wardrobe. Suddenly, the perfectly functional living room you have been happy with for five years feels dated.

That is the "Instagram/Pinterest Home" effect, and it could be changing India's renovation cycle.

At NoBroker Home Interiors, this shift is becoming visible even before the renovation conversation begins. Homeowners increasingly arrive at our interiors centres with saved Instagram posts, Pinterest boards and screenshots.



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

Around 35% of customers share social media references or inspirations when discussing their interiors.

The interesting part is that the motivation isn't always a pressing need to renovate. Sometimes, it is simply the feeling that my home could look better. The home makeover is becoming aspirational

For India's younger homeowners, especially modern couples, "good enough" is losing its grip

on the home. A house can be perfectly functional and still feel due for a change. The trigger is often not wear and tear, but weariness.

This is creating a more dynamic interiors market. Homeowners are refreshing spaces sooner, experimenting more and spending more on how their homes look and feel, from statement TV units and wall panelling to walk-in wardrobes and island kitchens.

Customers are now willing to spend 20%-30% more for interiors that feel premium, personalised and distinctly their own.

An island kitchen, for instance, is no longer just about additional counter space. It is becoming a social centre within the home. A walk-in wardrobe is as much about the experience of getting ready as it is about storage.

Post-pandemic change
This isn't just an Instagram

trend. The pandemic fundamentally changed the relationship Indians had with their homes.

For the first time, homes became offices, classrooms, gyms, restaurants and entertainment spaces simultaneously. People became acutely aware of poor lighting, inadequate storage, uncomfortable furniture and spaces that weren't designed around how they actually lived.

Then social media gave them the vocabulary to ar-

ticulate what they wanted.

For years, interiors remained a fragmented, largely offline category dominated by local contractors, carpenters and word-of-mouth recommendations. The digital consumer is now leapfrogging that model.

A homeowner can discover a design in Seoul, save a kitchen from a Mumbai influencer, compare finishes online and walk into an interiors centre already knowing the difference between fluted glass, PU and veneer.

Customer wants to see before buying

Digital commerce has also reset expectations. When consumers can virtually try on clothes, preview furniture in a room or customise products before buying, why should interiors require them to imagine the final outcome?

Customers increasingly want to visualise the kitchen before it is built, understand how a wardrobe will use available space and see how different materials change the character of a room.

The industry is therefore moving from selling a design promise to selling confidence in the final outcome.

Inspiration inflation

There is also an unintended consequence of the Instagram effect: inspiration inflation.

When consumers see hundreds of beautifully designed homes every week, ordinary begins to look inadequate. A home that would have felt aspirational five years ago can now

feel dated simply because the visual benchmark has moved.

This doesn't necessarily mean people are renovating their entire homes more often. It means they are becoming more conscious of what is possible and more demanding about what they eventually build.

Homeowners increasingly arrive with mood boards already in mind. There might be one saved image for the kitchen, another for the living room and something entirely different for the bedroom.

But liking individual spaces doesn't mean they work together. A Mediterranean kitchen, minimalist living room and maximalist bedroom may each look beautiful independently, but bringing them together requires an understanding of colour, materials, proportions, lighting and the overall character of the home.

Role interior expert

The value is no longer simply in executing what the customer asks for. It is in translating those inspirations into a home that feels cohesive, practical and uniquely theirs. The Pinterest effect is only the beginning. Social media hasn't necessarily created a need to renovate. It has changed what people consider a reason to renovate.

Boredom with an existing space can be enough. A lifestyle change can be enough. Moving into a new home can be enough. Or simply seeing a home online that makes someone think, "I want my house to feel like that."

The next phase of India's home interiors market may therefore be driven not only by the number of homes in need of renovation, but by the number of homeowners who have seen a home they now aspire to recreate in their own.

The writer is co-founder and CEO of NoBroker.

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THE HINDU
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Karnataka to consider extending Yellow Line to Attibele



The Karnataka government plans to extend the Namma Metro Yellow Line. It will go beyond Bommasandra towards Attibele.
SOURCE: The Economic Times, 10th August 2026

CREDAI

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CM YK

BG-BCE

A photograph of Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the left, wearing a white shirt and a yellow shawl, and a religious leader on the right, wearing an orange kurta. They are both holding a small statue of Lord Hanuman, which is standing on a green base. The statue is holding a bow and arrow. The background is a blurred outdoor setting.



Period	Share of Population Aged 65 and Over
2016-17	8%
2025-26	18%

Year	Number of Employees (lakh crore)
2016-17	2.96
2024-25	6.95

*lakh crore

- 



agri-markets & business

diversous, culture ecosystem

A small green seedling with several leaves growing out of a mound of dark brown soil. The seedling is positioned in the center of the slide, with its roots buried in the soil and its stem and leaves reaching upwards. The background is a light beige color with a subtle, repeating pattern of the same seedling motif, creating a textured effect.

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Sack Nagendra, reiterates Oppn. as Cong. says let House function

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Citing various works under progress, he said, "All these works will be completed by the end of November and water will be released by the end of December."

The Opposition has been disrupting the legislature sessions since August



(left) Police personnel attempting to stop BJP and JD(S) legislators' protest demanding the resignation of Planning and Statistics Minister B. Nagendra, in Bengaluru on Friday; Congress leaders, led by State party president B.K. Hariprasad, along with Mr. Nagendra, staging a protest in front of Mahatma Gandhi's statue at the Vidhana Soudha in Bengaluru on the same day. K. MURALI KUMAR



B.K. HARIPRASAD
KPCC president

Meanwhile, Congress Ministers and legislators, who staged a protest in

“If a corruption charge is proved, the party will seek resignation from the individual or suspend them. Seven BJP Chief Ministers in the country are facing serious charges. Let them not teach us lessons.”

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

For industries

Other Bills

The Cabinet has also approved tabling of the Karnataka Gram Swaraj and Panchayat Raj (Amendment) Bill, 2026, which seeks to replace an ordinance promulgated earlier to amend the rules that deal with taxation, rates and fee.

Amid din, apartment Bill, 2 others passed

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

As the Opposition continued to shout slogans against the Congress government and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi for inducting Mr. Nagendra in the State Cabinet, Speaker G.S. Patil ensured passage of three Bills and adjourned the session for Monday.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU



M.B. PATIL
Large and Medium Industries
Minister

KWIN City will have residential facilities and common amenities. The process of allotting space to suitable and reputed institutions will be taken up over the next year," he stated.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

“In Bengaluru, Deputy Commissioners of Police



Priyank Kharge

have been tasked to monitor the operation launched for the purpose under the title 'Operation Mukta'. Special drives have also been launched to identify illegal Bangladeshi migrants," the response noted. "Most of the identified Bangladeshi immigrants were working as rag-pickers. We are also keeping vigil and conducting investigations into individuals hiring such illegal immigrants," the response added.

Identified	Deported
Bengaluru City	656 505
Bengaluru district	44 33
Chikkamagaluru	5 0
Chitradurga	6 6
Mangaluru	23 1
Kolar	12 12
Shivamogga	12 12
Udipi	10 0
Raichur	1 1
Dharwad	2 2
Total	771 572

Recently, the Bengaluru City Police launched a special drive in the Whitefield division and identified 105 suspected illegal Bangladeshi immigrants. He noted that four cases have been booked against individuals involved in either spreading fake news about Bangladeshi nationals or assaulting them. Of the four cases, three were against Hindutva activists Puneeth Kerehalli and another accused, Nagen-drappa Shiruru.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Mr. Bangarappa said the investment will cover civil works and infrastructure development, classroom furniture, laboratory equipment, IT infrastructure and other facilities. Recurring expenditure will include teacher salaries, non-teaching staff, transport, administration, utilities, maintenance and other school-level operational requirements.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The witness is a social worker who helped the first-ever alleged victim to come forward and lodge a complaint against the former MP. The victim was a former househelp at the Revanna family's Holenarsipur house. This was the first case registered, based on which the SIT was formed.



A. Revanth Reddy

Centre denies approval for Telangana CM's U.S. trip

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The Centre has denied permission to Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy to visit the United States as part of his Telangana Rising initiative, prompting him to cut short his London tour and return to Hyderabad on August 23.

The Ministry of External Affairs, which had been approached by the State government for clearance for the Chief Minister's official visit to the U.K. and the U.S., approved only the U.K. leg of the tour.

The State government was informed of the decision after the delegation had already reached the U.K.

Reacting to the decision, Mr. Revanth Reddy said the objective of the U.S. visit was to bring some of the world's leading educational institutions to Telangana, in line with the objectives of the National Education Policy.

"I have always believed we should all think beyond politics and elections when it comes to nation building and the future of the youth," he said.

Sowcar Janaki, the versatile face of southern cinema, is no more

In her five-decade career, she effortlessly essayed a variety of roles; she started out as a drama artiste in AIR, and debuted in films *with Shavukaru* in 1950; she went on to captivate viewers with more than 400 films in Telugu, Tamil, and Kannada

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

Sowcar Janaki, known for her versatile roles in Tamil, Telugu and Kannada films, passed away in Chennai on Friday. She was 94.

The name 'Sowcar' became part of her name when she made her film debut in *Shavukaru* (1950), a Telugu film directed by L.V. Prasad. In Tamil, her entry began with the film *Valayapathi* (1952). She went on to be associated with some of the finest songs and roles, displaying style, majesty, and a range of expressions, in her five-decade career. She even earned the title 'weeping face'. But, she preferred to call herself a feminist.

Her first movie with Sivaji Ganesan was *Paavai Vilakku* (though the film *Pa-dikkatha Medhai* was released first).

A recipient of Padma Shri and Tamil Nadu's Kaimamani awards, she acted with three Chief Ministers of Tamil Nadu – M.G. Ramachandran, M. Karunanidhi and Jayalalithaa – and, in Telugu, with N.T. Rama Rao. She was one of the favourite actors of director K. Balachandran.

The song *Maalai-pozhuthin Mayakkathile Naan Kanavu Kanden Thozhi* from the film *Bhagyalakshmi* always conjures up the image of Ms. Janaki, who played a widow in the film. Another film, *Babu*, star-



SOWCAR JANAKI: 1931-2026

ring Sivaji Ganesan in the lead role, featured Ms. Janaki prominently as Sridevi's mother. In a way, her life resembled that of the film's mother – rich-turned-poor.

Born Sankaramanchi Janaki in 1931 at Rajahmundry (now Rajamahendravaram), Andhra Pradesh, into a Brahmin family, she grew up in a household where her father, who had studied paper-making technology in England, valued education. English was the language spoken at home.

The atmosphere was conservative, and watching films was taboo. Listening to the radio was her favourite pastime. She participated in dramas broadcast by the All India Radio and soon became an A-grade artiste because of her robust voice.

In an interview with actor Suhasini Manirntnam,

she had recalled how Telugu film producer Nagi Reddi, captivated by her voice, offered her a role in a film. But her family was against it, and she was forced to marry at the age of 15 to prevent her from acting. She became a mother at 17.

Ms. Janaki herself had spoken about the abject poverty she faced when she began her film career as a mother of two children. Her fortunes changed later.

Even though many female actors acted opposite Sivaji Ganesan, Ms. Janaki's acting in films such as *Puthiya Paravai*, *Uyarntha Manithan* and *Mahakavi Kalidas* measured up to the thespian's.

With her extraordinary hairstyle and Singapore-style costume, she would enter humming to the beats of bongos while Sivaji Ganesan lit a cigarette in *Puthiya Paravai*. Her ex-

A journey spanning generations, iconic stars

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

'Sowcar' Janaki, who passed away at 94 on Friday, starred in some prominent Kannada movies in her illustrious career as a multilingual actor. Her long on-screen association with thespian Dr. Rajkumar is one of the highlights of her remarkable film journey.

Ms. Janaki had featured in legendary filmmaker B.R. Panthulu's *Rathnagiriya Rahasya* (1957), an adventure film starring Uday Kumar. She had, in fact, acted in Uday Kumar's debut, *Bhagyodaya* (1956).

"Janaki's English-speaking abilities stood out. She was also known for choosing progressive characters," said film historian K. Puttaswamy.

After debuting in Kannada with *Devakannika* (1953), Ms. Janaki essayed prominent characters in the 1960s and 70s. Panthulu's *School Master*, an acclaimed social drama, is another noted Kannada work from Ms. Janaki.

Her next Kannada pro-

ject was also a milestone movie. B.S. Ranga's *Mahishasura Mardini* (1959) is considered the first major pan-Indian movie. The movie, starring Dr. Rajkumar, Uday Kumar and Nara-simharaju, was dubbed into seven languages following its immense popularity in Kannada.

Kanyarathna (1962), *Saaku Magalu* (1963), and *Navakoti Narayana* (1964) were other prominent Janaki-Rajkumar combination movies. In her second stint with Kannada cinema, Ms. Janaki excelled as a character artiste. She played Dr. Rajkumar's mother in *Thayige Thakka Maga* (1978) and featured in Shankar Nag's action movie *Aarada Gaya* (1980).

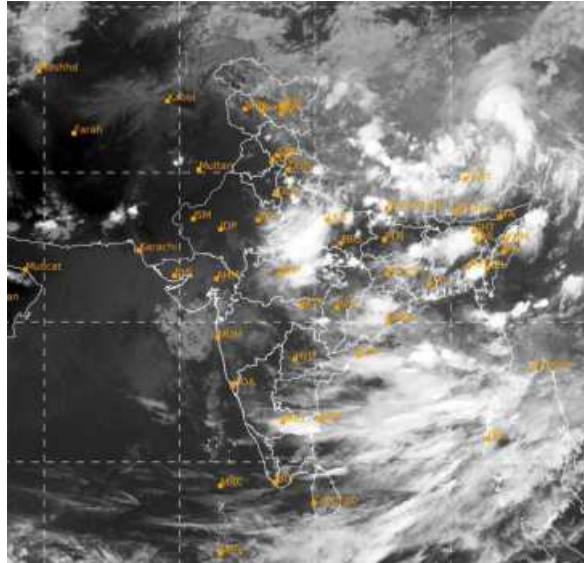
While she was part of the ensemble in Puneeth Rajkumar's blockbuster *Abhi* (2003), she once again essayed Dr. Rajkumar's mother in the actor's final film, *Shabdavedhi* (2000). Ms. Janaki's final Kannada movie was *Pungi Daasa* (2013), starring comedian-turned-hero Komal Kumar, brother of noted actor Jaggesh.

pression in the song *Paaritha Gnaabagam Illaiyo* was stunning. Her role in tormenting Sivaji Ganesan

throughout the film, particularly in the song *Enga Nimmathi, Enga Nimmathi*, is another milestone.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Saturday: Heavy to Very Heavy Rainfall very likely at isolated places over East Madhya Pradesh. Heavy Rainfall very likely at isolated places over Assam & Meghalaya, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, East Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Chandigarh & Delhi, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu-Kashmir, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura, Odisha, Punjab, Sub Himalayan West Bengal & Sikkim, Uttarakhand

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	004.0	21.0	27.0	Kurnool	—	33.7	25.8
Ahmedabad	000.2	31.0	26.6	Lucknow	—	35.6	27.6
Aizawl	039.0	28.8	28.8	Madurai	—	39.4	25.1
Bangaluru	006.3	32.4	20.3	Mangaluru	000.2	29.5	24.6
Bhopal	—	26.6	23.4	Mumbai	000.2	32.6	26.6
Bhubaneswar	—	34.4	24.4	Mysuru	—	30.2	19.6
Chandigarh	—	34.3	25.7	New Delhi	—	35.0	25.2
Chennai	—	36.4	26.8	Patna	—	35.6	29.0
Coimbatore	001.5	32.1	22.6	Port Blair	008.5	28.0	26.0
Dehradun	007.5	37.2	23.9	Prayagraj	002.5	35.2	27.4
Gangtok	012.8	27.3	18.2	Puducherry	009.2	35.9	25.2
Goa	006.0	32.0	24.6	Pune	000.6	29.3	21.2
Guwahati	010.8	35.3	26.5	Raipur	004.1	27.9	24.4
Hubballi	000.0	30.0	00.0	Ranchi	—	31.4	22.6
Hyderabad	—	31.8	24.5	Shillong	013.0	30.4	18.4
Imphal	—	32.3	23.8	Shimla	002.2	26.0	16.6
Jaipur	001.4	34.3	27.2	Srinagar	—	32.5	19.5
Kochi	001.2	30.2	26.2	Thiruvananthapuram	—	32.1	24.7
Kohima	000.0	30.0	00.0	Tiruchirappalli	—	39.5	27.6
Kolkata	—	36.5	27.6	Vijayawada	000.6	34.0	25.1
Kozhikode	—	33.4	25.4	Visakhapatnam	—	34.8	27.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	
Ahmedabad	—	34	12	55	110		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sasaram, Bihar
Bangaluru	—	10	103	38	10		recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of
Chennai	—	1	—	17	31		226 indicating an
Delhi	—	9	27	68	125		unhealthy level of
Hyderabad	—	13	12	38	47		pollution. In contrast,
Kolkata	—	5	28	41	78		Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a
Lucknow	—	6	23	33	43		healthy AQI score of 17
Mumbai	—	3	7	20	35		
Pune	—	—	26	30	35		
Visakhapatnam	—	18	70	24	69		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Mangaluru to come under SWR's Mysuru Division from October 1

Anil Kumar Sastry
MANGALURU

The Railway Ministry on Friday ordered the transfer of the Mangaluru Railway

Region from Southern Railway's Palakkad Division to South Western Railway's (SWR) Mysuru Division. The move fulfils the long-standing demand to bring

the region under SWR, which has been pending since 2003. Railway Board Executive Director (Efficiency and Research) Dinesh Kumar Vashishtha

said the competent authority had decided to transfer the Mangaluru area up to Ullal (inclusive) from the Palakkad Division to the Mysuru Division with effect

from October 1. The Mangaluru area includes the Mangaluru Central, Mangaluru Junction, Panambur (New Mangalore Port), and Ullal railway stations.

CITY MUNICIPAL COUNCIL HOSAPETE
No:61644/CMC HOSPETE/TENDER/2026-27
TENDER NOTIFICATION (IFT) E-PROCUREMENT
Tenders are invited for the work mentioned below as per KTPP act 2000 in two cover system are invited from the Contractors/Firms registered in KPWD as mentioned below. In e-procurement the contractors / firms will have to upload all information, documents and rates etc., www.eproc.karnataka.govt.in any other information required can be obtained from the office of the CMC Hosapete during the working hours. Tender Last Date: 27-08-2026 TIME 5.00 PM Opening for Technical Bid will be on Date: 29-08-2026 TIME 5.30 PM OPENING PLACE OF TENDER: CMC HOSAPETE.
TENDER DETAILS: DMA/2026-27/WS/WORK_INDENT 61644. Providing and Laying HDPE Pipe line Balance Network for Siddalingappa Chowki, Rajajinagar, Sameer Layout, Aravind Nagar, Valisab layout, Meenakshi Layout and other Lanes At Ward No 09 in Hosapete City.
Estimate amount (in lakhs): 50.00
Sd/- Assistant Executive Engineer, CMC Hosapete.
Sd/- Municipal Commissioner, CMC Hosapete.
DIPR/Vijayanagar/2026-27/KSMCA/RO No/242

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
DIVISION KOPPAL. Phone No: 08539-222318. email: cepwdkpl2@gmail.com
IFT No. PWD/DK:TR:2026-27: 1833 **Date: 21-08-2026**
INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT)
The Executive Engineer, Public works Department Division Koppal invites tenders from the eligible tenderers as per standard bid documents on http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/Portal. Head of Account : 5054-04-337-0-01-154 MDR Improvements/2026-27 & KKRDB Micro Institutional Akshara Avishkara General / 2024-25 & 2025-26. Two cover Tender procedure as per Rule 28 of the KTPP Act shall be followed. For more information the contractor can contact the under signed during office hours on Phone No. 08539 – 222318 and all informations regarding tenders can be had from website http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Two (02) Works (Work Indent Nos: 37644 & 0278) Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders **02-09-2026** Time 16.00, Date and Time for opening of Technical Bid **03-09-2026** Time 16.30, Date and Time for opening of Financial Bid **07-09-2026** Time 16.00. Minimum & Estimate Maximum Amount **Rs. 360.00 Lakhs & Rs. 500.00 Lakhs**, respectively. The tender documents can be downloaded from the above website address, EMD, Date & Time for Pre-bid meeting, Tender Queries/Clarification & Other informations as mentioned in KPPP Portal. Any changes either in tender date or any other condition tenderers can view in KPPP Portal.
DIPR/Koppal/303/KSMCA/2026-27 **Sd/- EE, PWD Division, Koppal**

KRISHNA BHAGYA JALA NIGAM LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Under Taking)
Office of the Executive Engineer,
KBJNL.NRBC.Divn.No.6, Chikkahonnakuni,Tq: Devadurga.
Dist:Raichur-584 111. KARNATAKA.
No. KBJNL/NRBC/D-6/PB-2/Road/TND/2026-27/365 **DATED:18-08-2026**
SHORT TENDER NOTIFICATION
(ONLY THROUGH ELECTRONIC TENDER SYSTEM)
On behalf of the Managing Director, KBJNL, Bengaluru, the Executive Engineer KBJNL, NRBC, Division No.6, Chikkahonnakuni Tq: Devadurga, Dist: Raichur was invited in KW-3 on percentage in Two cover system from KPWD Class-III & above for the following Road work. The blank tenders can be obtained through website www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in and submitted through electronic tender box).
Formation of new Road, CD works & CC Drainage, shifting of electric poles along alignment of canal aqueduct of Lateral No.2 of WBC of NRBC Dy-9A. (KBJNL/2026-27/RD/WORK_INDENT3723) having of Rs.71.78Lakh and EMD of Rs.1.43Lakh.
The details of events for the above work is mentioned as below:-
1) The Contractors can have access to e-tendering documents from 21/08/2026 to 29/08/2026 upto 5.30PM. 2) Last Date of Receipt of the above Tenders will be 29/08/2026 up to 5.30 PM. 3) Technical Bid for cover-I will be opened in the office of the Executive Engineer, KBJNL, Division No.6, Chikkahonnakuni on 31/08/2026 @ 11.00 AM onwards. 4) Financial Bid for cover-II will be opened in the office of the Executive Engineer, KBJNL, Division No.6, Chikkahonnakuni on 05/09/2026 @ 11.00 AM (if possible).
For any clarification regarding the tenders please Contact <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> or office of the under signed during office hours on working days.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, KBJNL, NRBC, Division No.6, CHIKKAHONNAKUNI-584111
DIP/RCR/229/KSMCA/230/2026-27

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE
REMEMBRANCE
In loving memory

M. Shahabuddin Shah
10.01.1919 – 22.08.2011
“Indeed we belong to Allah, and indeed we towards Him we will return.”
Quran 2: 156
Fondly remembered By Family and Friends

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2, MEI Layout, Hesaraghatta Main Road, Bagalagunte, T. Dasarahalli, Bengaluru- 560 073.
No: BNCC-Z2/EE/DD/TEND/12/2026-27 **Date: 21.08.2026**
INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)
The Executive Engineer, Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2 invites tenders from registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD/ Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Providing Thermoplastic Painting for Rumbler strips, Lane Marking, Junction Markings, different types of sign boards, pilcon signals and Kerb stones, HRPC and other safety furniture's as per Traffic police requests in Dasarahalli Division. Approximate value of work: Rs. 202.47 Lakhs. EMD : Rs. 3,03,800/- Category : Others.

1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> 2) Pre-bid Meeting: **07.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.** 3) Last Date for uploading the Filled proposals: **15.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs.** 4) Opening of technical bids: **16.09.2026 after 16:00 hrs.** 5) Opening of financial bids: **After Approval of Technical bids.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.
Sd/- Executive Engineer Dasarahalli Division, Zone-2.

TAMILNADU FOREST PLANTATION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Tamilnadu Undertaking)
Thiru. R.Saravanakumar, B.Sc., Regional Manager
Subramaniapuram 5th Street South, Karaikudi. Sivagangai (District) PIN Code : 630 002.

E-tender cum e-auction for sale of Eucalyptus standing trees for pulpwood raised in the plantations of Pudukkottai, Karaikudi and Tirukoilur
Regions of Tamilnadu Forest Plantation Corporation Limited (TAFCONR)
Sale of Eucalyptus standing trees for pulpwood raised in the plantations of Pudukkottai, Karaikudi and Tirukoilur Regions of Tamilnadu Forest Plantation Corporation Limited, for the year 2026 -27 will be conducted by way of e-tender cum e-auction through <https://intenders.gov.in> (TN Tenders) portal. Those who are interested may register as bidder in the said portal by submitting required documents and digital signature certificates and participate in the e-tender cum e-auction. The terms of e-tender cum e-auction and Range wise details of plantations to be brought for Sale are available in the Tender Document. The bidders should regularly check the above portal for updates. The details relating to e-tender cum e-auction will also be available in the Notice Board of the respective Offices of Regional Managers.

Sl No	Name of the Region	Total No. of Eucalyptus Plantations	Total Area in ha	Total Anticipated yield in M.t	Date of e-tender cum e-auction	Time
	PUDUKKOTTAI					
1.	2 nd Rotation	14	468.74	15000	16.09.2026 (Wednesday)	From 10.00 am to 05.00 pm
	3 rd and 4 th Rotation	22	490.22	13475		
	TOTAL	36	958.96	28475		
	KARAIKUDI					
2.	2 nd Rotation	21	568.92	17000	21.09.2026 (Monday)	From 10.00 am to 05.00 pm
	TOTAL	21	568.92	17000		
	TIRUKOILUR					
3.	1 st and 2 nd Rotation	82	2266.06	57000	25.09.2026 (Friday)	From 10.00 am to 05.00 pm
	3 rd Rotation	83	1874.97	41975		
	TOTAL	165	4141.03	98975		

Note : The date, time and details of plantation for the subsequent e-tender cum e-auction will be available in the TN-Tenders website and will also be made available in the Notice Boards of the respective Regional Manager Offices.
The sale, harvesting and all consequential operations shall be subject to any order or direction passed by the Hon'ble High Court or any other competent authority from time to time. TAFCONR reserves the right to postpone, cancel, modify or withdraw the e-Tender cum e-Auction, either wholly or partly, without assigning any reason, and no bidder shall be entitled to claim compensation or damages on that account.
Contact
Pudukkottai Region office - 98427 56239 / 95855 57334
Karaikudi Region office - 94436 49768 / 63837 13415.
Tirukoilur Region office - 98404 84529 / 89032 03811
DIPR/ 742 /DISPLAY/2026
Regional Manager, (TAFCONR) Karaikudi.



Saving faces

Use of facial recognition equipment at protest sites is worrisome

India appears to be normalising the technical ability to subject political gatherings to searchable biometric surveillance without first having settled, through legislation and judicial oversight, the circumstances in which the state may lawfully do so. While the Delhi Police have continued to deny the use of excessive force and manhandling people involved in the Cockroach Janta Party protests, contrary to protestors’ testimonies, facial recognition equipment was present at the protest site while the demonstrations were on. According to its affidavit to the Supreme Court of India, the police deployed a facial recognition system (including Artificial Intelligence-enabled cameras to scan faces in real-time against a database), a mobile surveillance van and a command and control vehicle, smart spectacles for identifying individuals on the move, and drones and videographers; the van and the spectacles have been tied to private contractors. The police have also not addressed whether actual biometric processing occurred with every individual within the range of cameras. Even if the police discarded the images associated with infructuous checks, that the data may have been accessible to private contractors, whose terms of engagement are unclear, is worrisome. However, no statute governs the use of facial recognition systems; the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, whose data-processing obligations are not yet in force, still makes broad exemptions for state agencies. The Automated Facial Recognition System of the National Crime Records Bureau can be used to identify criminals, unidentified bodies, and so on, and the Criminal Procedure (Identification) Act 2022 expanded the set of records that the police may collect from specified persons. However, these actions are still only allowed *vis-à-vis* specific groups of people.

Irrespective of the constitutional validity of the police’s actions, the chilling effect on potential participants may also curtail the right to protest. The state has to pass a well-established proportionality test when interfering with the right to privacy. While the first question – the existence of a legitimate objective – already poses important challenges to facial recognition en masse, the technology is indiscriminate at the point of capture. After all, there is a less restrictive but equally effective alternative (e.g., conventional policing). At this time, far too many questions are unanswered – including over the data-processing agreements, access, legal provisions that authorised major decisions, and the expected rate of false positives – for the use of facial recognition with all protesters to be justified.

Noise annoys

India must enforce noise pollution regulations uniformly and consistently

In a February 2025 hearing in the matter of *Surendra Prasad vs State of Bihar*, the Patna High Court acknowledged DJ trolleys and loudspeakers to be a major source of noise in Patna. After criticising the Bihar State Pollution Control Board (BSPCB) for failing to curb the menace, Justice Rajiv Roy directed the BSPCB to obtain reports from the police about permissions granted to operators of these noise sources and the action taken. In October, the police said they had seized equipment, levied fines, and so on over three months in Patna, Barh, and Fatuha but had taken no action in Masaurhi, a picture Justice Roy called “unbelievable” for suggesting that there were no noise violations there. In the course of these hearings, Justice Roy also summoned police officers and upbraided boilerplate affidavits, among others. The High Court’s August 14 order was a continuation of this escalation, culminating – for now – in Statewide directives on the emission of high-decibel noise. Effectively, the High Court’s actions illustrate how dismal enforcement has become despite the existence of comprehensive laws. Courts have repeatedly said that people have a right under Article 21 to be protected from unlawful noise. Today, with episodic enforcement having become endemic, the Patna High Court becoming a quasi-regulator is, at least as a stopgap measure, creditable.

It is absurd to expect the public to complain about every DJ or horn before the police can respond. The High Court’s directions to the authorities to pursue routine rather than complaints-based enforcement and to have DJs, sound-system operators, and event halls register themselves with the subdivisional authorities are the sort of proactive enforcement that regulating noise pollution in particular warrants. In fact, the High Court’s order also touched on a practical, everyday understanding of how loud-noise violations occur when it directed loudspeakers to stop playing at 9.55 p.m., five minutes before the law’s 10 p.m. cut-off, effectively allowing time for operators to wind up rather than permit the deceptively innocuous practice of carrying on past 10 p.m. because “it is just a few minutes”. Loud noise is often produced by ordinary social events such as festivals, weddings, political campaigns, and religious events, and enforcing rules creates friction with people who believe they have a right to practise their culture as they deem fit. Also, governments have an incentive to tolerate, rather than antagonise, their constituents. At the same time, having operators register themselves so that officials can regulate all of them equally rather than sporadically can also eliminate selective interventions. In the final analysis, the success of the High Court’s latest order should be measured by whether the State develops a consistent habit of enforcement.

The Unified District Information System for Education Plus (UDISE+) 2025-26 report highlights notable progress in India’s school education system, covering 1.47 million schools, 240 million students, and 10.2 million teachers. Progress has been recorded in gross enrolment, student retention, dropout reduction, teacher availability, and educational infrastructure. However, the report also shows that regional and social disparities persist in access, resources, learning opportunities, and educational outcomes. Disparities in gross enrolment ratios (GER), dropout rates, pupil-teacher ratios, and infrastructure availability across regions and social groups indicate the ongoing challenge of guaranteeing equitable, inclusive, and quality education in India.

Regional and social imbalances

The report confirms that significant variations exist across socioeconomic groups and geographic regions in terms of various indicators. The distribution of enrolled students shows that Andhra Pradesh leads in Aadhaar seeding (99.6%), followed by Chandigarh (99%), while Meghalaya records the lowest rate (35%), compared with the national average of 90.2%. Uttar Pradesh accounts for the highest share of schools and student enrolment, while Meghalaya and Himachal Pradesh have the lowest shares of schools relative to enrolment, indicating higher student-school ratios.

At the school level, West Bengal has recorded the highest proportion of foundational and preparatory schools (79%) of total, and among the lowest secondary schools (11%); Chandigarh has the highest secondary schools (83%) and the lowest foundational and preparatory schools (5%) of total. The social composition of enrolled students shows significant variation across regions. Chandigarh and Delhi have the highest proportions of General category students, while Lakshadweep, Mizoram, Meghalaya, and Ladakh have high proportions of Schedule Tribe (ST) enrolment. Punjab records one of the highest shares of Scheduled Caste (SC) enrolment, whereas Other Backward Classes representation is particularly high in Tamil Nadu and Gujarat.

At the national level, the GER has recorded highest for OBCs (49%), followed by General (27%), SCs (17%), and STs (10%). Thus, GER indicates large differences in school education enrolment in comparison to their corresponding population of each social group.

The Gender Parity Index across all school levels shows higher girls’ enrolment and participation than boys across most of the States/Union Territories. The UDISE+ data show that students from minority communities account for more than 20% of enrolment, with



Sahab Deen

Project Scientist at the Remote Sensing Applications Centre, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh



Navneet Sharma

Teaches education at the Central University of Himachal Pradesh, Dharamshala

India’s educational progress needs stronger focus on equity, inclusion, accessibility, and quality

Muslims and Parsis among the major minority groups. The average enrolment per school shows that Chandigarh registers the highest average enrolment per school (1,194), followed by Delhi (788); while Ladakh records the lowest average enrolment (64), indicating variation in the size of the schools across the country.

The pupil-teacher ratio (PTR) is an important factor influencing students’ performance and achievement. The PTR varies highly, registering lowest in Union Territories and highest in densely populated States. A significant inter-State variation in PTR exists across pedagogical stages; i.e., foundational, preparatory, and middle PTRs are generally lower than secondary across most of the States. Jharkhand records the highest Secondary PTR (43), followed by Uttar Pradesh, signifying a heavy workload on teachers. On the other hand, Sikkim has the lowest secondary PTR (6), followed by Ladakh. The GER varies significantly at the levels of schools and regions across the country. Meghalaya records the highest Foundational GER (131), followed by Mizoram, while Bihar has the lowest GER (24), preceded by Uttar Pradesh. Meghalaya again records the highest Preparatory GER (171), followed by Manipur; whereas Gujarat has the lowest GER (74), preceded by Bihar. Chandigarh and Meghalaya record the highest Middle GER (118), followed by Delhi. On the contrary, Bihar has the lowest GER (70), preceded by Nagaland. Similarly, Chandigarh registers the highest Secondary GER (109), followed by Goa; while Bihar has the lowest GER (48), preceded by Nagaland.

The dropout rate determines the attainment and transition rate to the next stage of schools. Bihar accounts for the highest preparatory dropout rate (7.9%), followed by Meghalaya. On the other hand, many States/Union Territories such as Delhi, Haryana and Maharashtra do not report dropout. Similarly, Bihar records the highest middle-level dropout rate (9%), followed by Uttar Pradesh. While several States/Union Territories such as Chandigarh, Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh do not register dropouts at this stage, Ladakh records the highest secondary dropout rate (14.8%), followed by Karnataka. West Bengal has the lowest dropout rate (1.5%), preceded by Telangana.

Persistent gaps

Generally, access to schooling has improved significantly over the years. Most children now have a school at a suitable distance, but regional differences continue. Remotely located places, hilly, tribal and border areas still have limited schools and transport facilities, where school-going children face greater difficulties in attending school regularly, such as in Bageshwar district of Uttarakhand, Ganjam and Kandhamal districts of Odisha, Kathua district of Jammu and

Kashmir, and Palghar district of Maharashtra. Simultaneously, children from SCs, STs, minorities, and economically poor families have a greater likelihood to face different barriers that limit their enrolment, attendance, and completion of schooling.

School infrastructure has improved in several areas of the country, i.e., access to drinking water and electricity. However, the availability of infrastructure varies regionally across the country. Educationally backward districts are still struggling to provide a learning environment in rural schools in comparison to urban areas.

Teacher availability is a factor that significantly influences educational outcomes. The report shows that many States have recruited qualified teachers, while teacher shortages continue in several regions. Rural and remote schools often face a shortage of teachers performing multiple classes and subjects and many other non-teaching responsibilities allotted by the government. High student-teacher ratios reduce the individual attention students receive and adversely affect the learning process. Despite progress in girls’ schooling, challenges persist in reducing dropout rates, enhancing transition from primary to secondary education, and providing sufficient and suitable facilities for disabled children. Inclusive infrastructure, accessible classrooms, and supportive teaching practices are essential for equitable education.

Targeted investment will help

The UDISE+ 2025-26 report shows that educational inequality persists across accessibility, infrastructure, teacher availability, digital resources, and social inclusion. Addressing these dimensions collectively is essential for equitable educational development. In line with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, targeted investment in educationally deprived regions, improved digital infrastructure, adequate teacher deployment, and stronger support for disadvantaged groups can help bridge persistent gaps.

Regional and social imbalances continue to influence educational opportunities and learning conditions. Reducing these disparities requires a balanced approach that collectively improves infrastructure, promotes equitable teacher deployment, strengthens inclusive social and economic policies, and provides dedicated support for disadvantaged social groups. A regionally and socially balanced approach that integrates educational quality, equity, and accessibility will help create a more inclusive education system, address the paradox of progress in India’s evolving school education landscape, and contribute to the country’s long-term social, economic, and regional development.

Unimpeded trade needs IPMDA as the answer



Pooja Bhatt

Teaches maritime geopolitics at the O.P. Jindal Global University

Despite the diplomatic difficulties in United States-India relations due to mounting sanctions, it is increasingly clear that Washington needs regional powers such as New Delhi to support common global interests and values. Amid the U.S. visa issues for Indians and the energy crisis stemming from the war in West Asia, Indian and U.S. Foreign and Commerce Ministers have underscored the need for reciprocal trade and energy agreements. While the prime objectives in the present relations are clear, the strategy needs renewed focus on maritime domain awareness (MDA), which is crucial for the ‘unimpeded trade’ and has been unequivocally agreed to by both sides.

The Indo-Pacific is a trade artery

The West Asia crisis has demonstrated that the Indo-Pacific is not only a crucial geostrategic location for India and the U.S. but also for the rest of the world. Geoeconomically, it is the circulatory system of the global economy, a vast maritime corridor through which nearly \$7 trillion in trade flows annually, connecting energy producers in the Persian Gulf to manufacturing hubs in East Asia and consumer markets across the Americas. Some of the world’s busiest maritime chokepoints, the Straits of Malacca, the Lombok, and the Sunda, Hormuz, Bab-al-Mandeb, and Mozambique channels sit squarely within its waters, crucial for both energy and container supplies. Yet, this indispensable artery of global commerce is increasingly being threatened by a convergence of state-sponsored coercion, illegal maritime activity, and a dangerous surveillance gap – geographically, jurisdictionally and institutionally – that even the U.S. is finding challenging to address alone.

The Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness (IPMDA) launched under the Quad framework in 2022, represents the most credible multilateral architecture yet devised to address this problem. It is a practical, technology-based mechanism for sharing near-real-time maritime data across partner nations to detect, deter, and respond to threats to the free flow of trade. And its full

Maritime cooperation through the Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness (IPMDA) can strengthen the Indo-Pacific’s trading system

operationalisation is anchored in robust U.S.-India cooperation under Quad (India, Australia, Japan, the U.S.), which is now a strategic imperative. At the technological level, in 2025, India has already purchased SeaVision technology from the U.S., which includes software enhancements, training, and logistical support necessary for mutual MDA cooperation.

A surveillance deficit

The Indo-Pacific suffers from a persistent and widening maritime surveillance deficit. As a multilayered technological assimilation, MDA provides an effective understanding of the maritime domain and its impacts on security, safety, the economy, and the environment.

Across the broader waters of the Indian Ocean, which connect to the South China Sea and the Western Pacific, hundreds of vessels routinely disable their Automatic Identification System (AIS) transponders – a phenomenon analysts call “going dark” – likely to evade sanctions, conceal cargo, and cause safety and environmental threats.

Such vessels may also be engaged in smuggling or ship-to-ship transfers of contraband. Many smaller fishing vessels fall outside mandatory AIS transponder carriage requirements, and depending on the applicable national and international regulatory framework, they are also found engaged in illegal fishing practices in other nations’ waters or even at high seas. This depletes regional stocks and undermines the food security of littoral states.

Furthermore, as witnessed in recent times, non-state as well as state-affiliated actors are conducting grey-zone operations designed to intimidate and coerce, while escaping any legal or conventional military response. The Quad’s Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration 2026 (IPMSC), under the IPMDA architecture, is as elegant in its pragmatism as in its cooperation, based on a shared understanding that no country can monitor the vast oceans alone. By integrating data from commercial satellite-based radio-frequency monitoring, radar fusion, and existing partner-nation sensor networks, and

sharing it with like-minded partners, it creates a layered, near-continuous picture of maritime activities.

The beneficiaries

For the U.S., regional cooperation in the Indian Ocean is essential if it aims to focus on its immediate neighbourhood in the Pacific and the Atlantic. For India, its Information Fusion Centre-Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR), established in Gurugram in 2018, is a natural institutional complement to IPMDA’s regional hub architecture. IPMDA is precisely the kind of arrangement that respects India’s sovereignty while amplifying its reach. With the basics already in place, U.S.-India cooperation is necessary but not sufficient.

The full potential of IPMDA/IPMSC will be realised only through the active participation of existing Quad partners as well as the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) partner states, the Pacific Island nations that constitute critical maritime corridors. The European Union, which has upheld the importance of free and open trade since the Hormuz crisis, signals an appetite for engagement that Washington and New Delhi must cultivate.

The contributions and benefits of IPMDA/IPMSC for smaller, capacity-constrained partners, such as Bangladesh, the Maldives, the Seychelles, Sri Lanka, and Fiji, are significant. These countries have independent surveillance infrastructure, but their waters are frequently exploited because these systems remain ineffective at addressing maritime crimes beyond their jurisdictions. This provides an opportunity for collaboration.

The strategic environment in the Indo-Pacific has systematically dismantled the assumption that open trade is unilaterally sustainable. The freedom of navigation upon which global supply chains depend is increasingly contested, and such contestation, un rebutted, has become precedent in recent years. In a region where coercion has increasingly become the currency of power, transparency must present itself as a form of deterrence.

Sowcar Janaki

The passing of veteran actor Sowcar Janaki has caused a deep shock and left an even greater vacuum in the world of acting. She left little unexplored in the art of acting and portraying diverse characters on the silver screen. Every scene

and every character she portrayed was a lesson and an example for those who aspired to pursue acting as a career.

S. Muthusubramaniyan,
Coimbatore

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

GROUND ZERO



A farmer sits in his dry paddy field at Vilakudi near Thiruthuraiipoondi in Tiruvavur district of Tamil Nadu. R. VENGADESH

A dry spell along the Cauvery river

A weak monsoon has left farmers on both sides of the Cauvery struggling with dwindling water supplies. In Karnataka, farmers are worried about irrigation even as the State faces pressure to release water to Tamil Nadu, where large tracts of paddy fields remain barren. The competing demands have sharpened tensions between the two States. **Laiqh A. Khan** and **T. Ramakrishnan** report on the plight of farmers

Marilingaiah, a farmer from Karnataka’s Kuntanahalli village in Maddur taluk of Mandya district, has raised a nursery of paddy seedlings on his two-acre plot. He is waiting for water to reach his fields, which lie at the tail end of the Visvesvaraya irrigation canal system. The canal draws water from the Krishna Raja Sagara (KRS) reservoir, located across the Cauvery river near Mysuru.

Worried, he says, “If water does not flow into the fields in the next 10 days, I will not only have to give up hopes of sowing paddy, but also lose the ₹8,000 I have spent on raising the nursery.”

Marilingaiah knows that adequate rainfall, along with canal water, is essential for the paddy to survive. Yet, he is among the many farmers in Karnataka’s Cauvery basin who have defied official advice against sowing water-intensive crops such as paddy and sugarcane this season, amid a predicted deficient monsoon and inadequate inflows into the basin’s reservoirs.

The optimism of the farmers was fuelled by a brief revival of the monsoon in the first week of August, when the water level in the 124.8-foot KRS reservoir rose from 93-94 ft to over 100 ft within a few days, before stagnating at 109 ft.

While farmers like Marilingaiah have chosen to trust nature instead of switching to semi-dry crops such as ragi, pulses, or oilseeds, others are waiting for a clearer picture to emerge. D.K. Ramu of Kodihalli village in Maddur taluk and Raju of Siddapura village in Srirangapatna taluk are among them. “If there is a promise of water in the next few days, I will sow paddy. Otherwise, I will grow ragi,” Ramu says. However, he notes that heavy rain could also damage the ragi crop.

Farmers across Karnataka’s Cauvery basin are facing not only the pressure of a deficient monsoon and uncertainty over the availability of irrigation water, but are also concerned about the need to share the limited Cauvery water with neighbouring Tamil Nadu – a vexed issue that goes back more than 130 years.

Meanwhile, in Tamil Nadu, farmers in the Cauvery delta are facing a water crisis of their own. Low storage at the Mettur dam, Karnataka’s failure to release a sufficient share of the water it received in June and July, and the Tamil Nadu government’s decision not to open the dam for irrigation on the customary date of June 12 have left large tracts of paddy fields barren. The State continues its legal battle with Karnataka to secure its share of the Cauvery water.

Balancing competing water needs

With the monsoon falling short and reservoir levels under pressure, Karnataka has had to balance irrigation needs with drinking water requirements and its obligations under the Cauvery water-sharing arrangement.

On August 19, the Cauvery Irrigation Advisory Committee, a regional body chaired by Karnataka Water Resources Minister N. Cheluvarayaswamy, met in Bengaluru and decided to release canal water in only four rotational cycles during the crop season, instead of continuously. This decision was taken to conserve reservoir storage and



If water does not flow into the fields in the next 7-10 days, I will not only have to give up hopes of sowing paddy, but also lose the ₹8,000 I have already spent on raising the nursery.

MARILINGAIAH
Farmer from Karnataka

to ensure water availability for other needs, including for drinking.

Devaraj, a farmer from Attahalli village near Mysuru, says the plan to release water for about 15 days and then stop it for the next 15 days will not provide enough water for paddy and sugarcane crops. “Farmers will be able to grow only dry crops,” he says.

The State is also under pressure from the Supreme Court and the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) to share the limited water with Tamil Nadu in what is shaping up to be a distress year. This central body was set up in June 2018 by the Union government to handle water-sharing from the Cauvery among Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and Puducherry

On August 11, Karnataka appealed to the CWMA to immediately reduce water releases to Tamil Nadu from 12,000 cusecs (cubic feet per second) per day to 10,000, warning that there will be severe drinking water shortage if more water is released for crops in the Cauvery basin.

With water to be released under the rotational cycle only as long as reservoir levels permit, State Sugarcane Farmers’ Association president Kurub Shanthakumar questions whether the Karnataka government and its legal team were making a strong enough case for farmers and presenting the State’s position before the Cauvery water-sharing bodies – the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC) and the CWMA – and the Supreme Court. He says the legal team does not appear to have succeeded in convincing the authorities about the water crisis in Karnataka.

Farmers in Maddur taluk are also bracing for a confrontation with the State government over the proposed diversion of KRS water to the Cauvery Stage VI drinking water project for Bengaluru, which requires an additional 6 TMC (thousand million cubic feet) of water annually. The Cauvery Stage VI drinking water project is a ₹6,939-crore infrastructure initiative approved by the Karnataka government this February to supply 500 MLD (million litres per day) of Cauvery water to roughly 30 lakh residents in Bengaluru as well as the adjoining towns of Bidadi, Hos-



Marilingaiah, a farmer from Kuntanahalli in Karnataka, is hoping that water will reach his fields soon. M.A. SRIRAM

kote, Anekal, Devanahalli, and Nelamangala.

“Is it fair for the government to starve us of water while diverting it to Bengaluru? Shouldn’t it identify other sources of drinking water for the city instead,” asks Mallesh, a Kuntanahalli resident, who is also a journalist.

A season of uncertainty

While farmers at the canal’s tail end bear the brunt of the distress, paddy transplantation is nearly complete in areas closer to the KRS reservoir, such as Karekura and Hosahalli. In a paddy field in Hosahalli, Cheluvvaraju says most farmers in the region typically grow two crops a year given the usual availability of water. But his hopes for a second crop this year have dimmed as reserves have depleted. “We are not sure if we will be able to raise the second crop,” he says.

Cheluvvaraju adds that he may have to work as a labourer to make ends meet if he is unable to grow the second crop. Most agricultural labourers in the region earn ₹400-500 for a day’s work from 7 a.m. to noon. The deficient monsoon has also cast a shadow over sugarcane fields. Farmers who have already harvested their crops are relieved, but many others are pinning their hopes on rain. Chikkalingaiah, a farmer from Chikka-byadarahalli in Pandavapura taluk, says his sugarcane crop needs another nine months before harvest – and without timely rain, it may not even be fit to use as cattle fodder.

Many farmers have taken not only interest-free short-term loans from primary agricultural co-operative credit societies, but also high-interest loans from microfinance companies. “If we are unable to grow crops, how will we repay our loans,” asks Nagesh, a resident of Chikkanahalli. He believes that the government should waive farmers’ agricultural loans and take steps to stop microfinance companies, notorious for deploying aggressive recovery agents, from harassing borrowers.

Though the despair among farmers over poor rainfall and the release of water to Tamil Nadu is reflected in the occasional protests, staged mostly by farmers’ organisations and pro-Kannada outfits across different parts of the Cauvery basin, these demonstrations, unlike in previous years, have remained muted. Even the Karnataka bandh, called by Kannada activist Vatal Nagaraj on August 13, drew a lukewarm response, barring parts of Maddur taluk.

Sunanda Jayaram, Organising Secretary of the Mandya District Raithara Hitharakashana Samithi, a farmers’ welfare committee, says with regret that farmers, the main stakeholders in the Cauvery water-sharing issue, were not responding to the calls for struggle.

An agriculturalist in Kuntanahalli, however, points to a different reason: ruling Congress leaders, he says, are actively discouraging farmers from taking to the streets, cautioning them against falling into what they call an “Opposition trap” – joining the protests only to later face the hassle of police stations and court appearances.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has chastised activists for staging protests over the Cauvery issue “for the sake of publicity.” In particular, he warned them against wading into the river – a common form of protest – after the Water Resources Department issued a flood alert earlier this month over the release of water from the near-brimming Kabini reservoir.

While acknowledging that Karnataka’s dams were not yet full, Shivakumar vowed to protect the interests of the State’s farmers. But he has also emphasised the need to uphold the law by complying with directions on the release of Cauvery water to Tamil Nadu.

Crisis in the Cauvery delta

“Very bad, very depressing situation” is how Thanga Jayaraman, an agriculturist from Tiruvavur, describes the situation in Tamil Nadu’s Cauvery delta, considered the rice bowl of the State.

“Ordinarily, when water is released from the Mettur dam (built in Salem district in Tamil Nadu

across the Cauvery) on June 12 for irrigation, it reaches our area, about 300 kilometres downstream, by June 23 or 24. But this year, nothing,” says Jayaraman, who taught English at several institutions of higher education before taking up farming after retirement.

A drive of over 200 km from Tiruchi through Thanjavur, Thiruvaiyaru, Tiruvavur, and Mannargudi shows largely barren paddy fields. “You should have come last year. You would have found greenery everywhere,” says A.T.B. Balamurugan, a farmer of Andaankarai, about 15 km from Thiruthuraiipoondi in Thiruvavur district.

Ordinarily, paddy is cultivated across 5.3 lakh acres in the Cauvery delta during the ongoing short-term Kuruvai season, followed by cultivation across 12.9 lakh acres during the longer Samba-Thaladi season, which begins with transplantation in late July or early August and ends with the harvest in mid-January. According to Tamil Nadu government data, the area under paddy cultivation this year has fallen to 4.5 lakh acres.

However, some agriculturists dispute the figure. They say there have been instances of stunted growth and crops showing signs of withering, making the official figure unreliable. The impact, they say, extends beyond the fields.

“Economic activity in the region is getting crippled because of the erosion of livelihood opportunities,” says P.R. Pandian, president of the Tamil Nadu All Farmers Organisations’ Coordination Committee and a resident of Mannargudi. “Shops and other businesses here down their shutters by 7 p.m.”

Located along the eastern coast of the State, the Cauvery delta, spanning districts such as Thanjavur, Tiruvavur, Mayiladuthurai, and Nagapattinam, is characterised by fertile alluvial soil and a tropical climate with the flow of the Cauvery. Its importance can be gauged from the fact that during the procurement year of 2025-26 (September 1, 2025 to July 31, 2026), the region contributed 39.5 lakh tonnes of paddy out of the State-wide procurement of 57.5 lakh tonnes.



Ordinarily, when water is released from the Mettur dam on June 12 for irrigation, it reaches our area by June 23 or 24. But this year, nothing.

THANGA JAYARAMAN
Agriculturist from Tiruvavur

Yet many parts of the zone remain economically backward with a majority of the population depending on agriculture for livelihood, despite climate challenges. Scheduled Castes, who live in large numbers in the region, constitute the dominant segment of landless agricultural labourers.

These are the reasons why successive Tamil Nadu governments have been keen to protect the interests of the Cauvery delta.

Opening the Mettur dam

This year, given the poor forecast for the south-west monsoon, attributed to super El Nino, the government chose not to open the Mettur dam on June 12. “The authorities should not release water from the dam until the water level reaches at least 100 ft,” says Pandian. The level is now about 85 ft, against the full capacity of 120 ft.

The Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal and the Supreme Court have provided for greater share of the river water to be released by Karnataka to Tamil Nadu during the south-west monsoon (123.14 TMC out of the annual quota of 177.25 TMC). This share is mostly meant to support paddy cultivation during the Samba season.

The Samba crop is important not only for food security but is also the mainstay of the delta’s rural economy. Farmers also grow the shorter-duration Kuruvai crop, which can offer higher yields. This crop is largely dependent on groundwater, with farmers using energised pumpsets to irrigate their fields. But declining groundwater levels and salinity are making even this option increasingly difficult.

“My area is located between the Cauvery and one of its branches, the Coleroon (Kollidam). Even there, the water level is going down,” says R. Arivalagan, a farmer from Peramur, about 10 km from Thiruvaiyaru. Submersible pumpsets, once more common in the dry districts of Coimbatore and Dharmapuri, have become commonplace in the delta too. Over-extraction of groundwater has also led to salinity ingress in many areas.

So far, the Tamil Nadu government has not announced when the Mettur dam will be opened, even as it continues its legal battle with Karnataka to secure Tamil Nadu’s share of the Cauvery water. The government has strongly opposed Karnataka’s push to reduce water releases, pressing the Supreme Court to ensure strict adherence to the mandated 12,000 cusecs daily flow.

At the 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council held at Mamallapuram and presided over by Union Home Minister Amit Shah, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay said the legitimate rights of lower riparian States and the livelihoods that depend on assured river flows must be fully protected.

Meanwhile, several farmers’ groups have also begun demanding compensation for crop losses. They are unhappy with the crop loan waiver scheme announced by Vijay and are seeking a full, unconditional waiver of up to ₹1 lakh for all farmers who have taken crop loans.

Officials are also hoping that the monsoon will revive, with about a month left in the season. Any compensation for crop losses, meanwhile, will be subject to the Union and State governments’ norms for natural disasters and a survey by the departments concerned.

S. Vivekanandan, a farmer of Vilakudi, is increasingly worried over the prospects of the Samba crop. A senior official says that as the government is closely watching, it will take steps to safeguard the farmers of the Cauvery delta.

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A DO DO5

Ethanol blending policy is behind rise in sugar prices, says Opposition

Sugar prices went up from ₹48 to ₹67 a kg over last three months, says Congress, blaming the diversion of sugar cane for fuel; asks why petrol prices were not reduced despite falling global crude rates; Kejriwal says government run by 'illiterates'

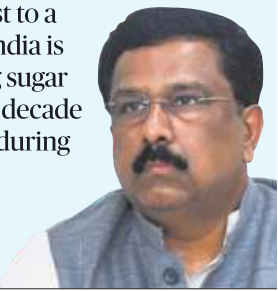
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The diversion of sugar cane and food-grains for ethanol production is driving food prices higher, the Congress said on Friday, adding that vehicles not designed for 20% ethanol-blended fuel face mileage and compatibility problems. The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) too claimed that diverting sugar cane towards ethanol production has reduced sugar output, pushing sugar prices up by ₹20 per kg in just 17 days.

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government at the Centre had, on Thursday, allowed duty-free imports of 10 lakh tonne of raw sugar under a Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) till October 31, amid the rising prices of the sweetener in

As more sugarcane is diverted towards ethanol, domestic sugar prices have surged nearly 20% in August to a record ₹5,350 per 100 kg. India is now considering importing sugar for the first time in nearly a decade to meet domestic demand during the festival season

SYED NASEER HUSSAIN
Congress MP



local markets. The move is aimed at enhancing domestic availability and capping price rise.

Immediate review

In a post on X, Congress communications chief Jai-ran Ramesh demanded an immediate review of the E20 fuel policy and sought the provision of non-ethanol petrol options.

"The people are paying

the price for both expensive food and expensive travel because of the wrong decisions of the arrogant Modi government," Mr. Ramesh said, adding that "a fuel policy under which both the vehicle and the kitchen become expensive" could not be acceptable to the country.

According to the figures cited by Mr. Ramesh, sugar prices have risen from ₹48

to ₹67 a kg and jaggery prices from ₹50 to ₹65 a kg over the past three months. Rice and maize flour, he said, have become costlier by 16% and 11%, respectively, while animal feed prices have risen 10.34%.

The Congress leader also asked why there was no cut in petrol prices despite a decline in international crude oil prices and lower costs resulting from 20% ethanol blending. He alleged that alternatives to petrol had been limited to benefit ethanol producers, while serious questions remained over the impact of E20-blended petrol on vehicle mileage and compatibility.

Food security

Congress Rajya Sabha MP Syed Naseer Hussain said the Modi government's ag-

gressive push for E20 was compromising India's food security. "As more sugarcane is diverted towards ethanol, domestic sugar prices have surged nearly 20% in August to a record ₹5,350 per 100 kg. India is now considering importing sugar for the first time in nearly a decade to meet domestic demand during the festival season," he said in a post on X.

AAP convener Arvind Kejriwal said in a video message that the government started making ethanol from sugarcane in order to save foreign exchange spent on oil imports. "Now, they will import sugar using that foreign exchange," he said. "It's a government entirely run by illiterates. No one knows what will happen if they do something," he added.

Crop damage, production dip, and festival demand led to price hike, says govt.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

As 18 States and Union Territories witnessed an increase of ₹10 to ₹18 for a kilogram of sugar within one year, the Union government said on Friday that it was closely monitoring the situation and had taken steps to stabilise the prices.

On Friday, Odisha registered the highest price for sugar – ₹64.72 for a kilogram, which was ₹17.80 higher than in the same date of 2025, followed by Madhya Pradesh and Punjab.

Other than Odisha, consumers from Assam, Delhi, Goa, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Meghalaya, Punjab, Tripura and West Bengal also paid over ₹60 for a kilogram of sugar on Friday. The national average price was ₹58.23.

Compared to the same date of last month, Madhya



18 States and U.T.s witnessed an increase of ₹10 to ₹18 for a kilogram of sugar in one year.

Pradesh witnessed an increase of ₹15.70 per kg, followed by Punjab, where the increase was ₹14.67 per kg. Compared to Friday of last week, Madhya Pradesh saw the sharpest increase of ₹11.82, followed by Odisha, rising by ₹10.67.

The Union Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution said in a statement that sugar prices had increased in recent weeks, from ₹48.18 per kg on July 20, to ₹55.70 per kg on August 20. "The go-

vernment has taken a series of measures to ensure adequate availability of sugar and stable prices for consumers," the statement said, and maintained that rise in sugar prices could not be attributed to ethanol. "It is incorrect to attribute the recent increase in sugar prices to diversion of sugar for ethanol production. In fact, the share of sugar diverted for ethanol has declined from around 12% in 2022-23 to around 9% in 2025-26," the statement added.

The government added that the present increase in sugar prices was due to a combination of factors, including lower-than-expected domestic production, increased demand ahead of the festive season, weather-related damage to the sugarcane crop, tightening global sugar supplies and hoarding by some sections of the industry.

'National Song shows India must embrace cultural nationalism'

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Friday said it was "unfortunate" that even after Independence, *Vande Mataram* was not accepted "wholeheartedly" in the country. He hailed the 80th Independence Day celebration at the Red Fort as a "unique occasion" that included the full rendition of the National Song.

"Through this single song, this single literary creation, Bankim Chandra Chatterjee established that independent India must



Amit Shah

move forward by embracing cultural nationalism. It is unfortunate that even after Independence and the Partition of the country, *Vande Mataram* was never wholeheartedly embraced," the Home Minister said, addressing a gathering

in West Bengal's Siliguri.

His remarks came amid the Congress party's recent announcement to feature only the first two stanzas of the National Song at party functions, a move which Mr. Shah has described as "anti-national".

The Home Minister termed the enhancement of the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Act, 2026, a "historic decision".

In Siliguri, the Minister inaugurated exhibitions with information on the three criminal laws.

Rahul's sit-in is cheap politics, meant to divert attention from row over *Vande Mataram*: BJP

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The BJP on Friday alleged that Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi attempted to divert public attention by holding a sit-in at the Parliament Street police station after getting cornered over the *Vande Mataram* issue.

Mr. Gandhi staged a dharna at the police station, demanding the registration of a case in connection with pellet injuries sustained by 19-year-old

Sahil Lochab during the Cockroach Janta Party-led protest in Jantar Mantar.

Union Minister J.P. Nadda described the move as "cheap and diversionary politics", saying that "Rahul Gandhi ji's protest today is neither for students nor for justice; it is a symbol of the Congress party's political desperation and Rahul Gandhi's insatiable hunger for 'footage'."

Judicial matter

The BJP leader said the Supreme Court has already taken cognisance of the Ju-

Union Minister Nadda says dharna at a police station shows Cong. leader's 'hunger for footage'

ly 20 incident and constituted a five-member high-powered committee. "When the country's highest court is investigating the matter, what does Rahul Gandhi seek to prove by sitting outside a police station in front of the cameras? Has the Leader of Opposition lost faith in the

country's judiciary?" he asked.

He said the police informed Mr. Gandhi that the Crime Branch was already conducting an intensive probe into all the cases related to July 20 protest and assured him that the incident flagged by him was also being referred to the Crime Branch. "Despite this clarification from the administration, sitting on a protest demonstrates Rahul Gandhi's obstinacy and exposes the Congress party's desperation," said Mr. Nadda.

Questioning the timing of the sit-in, he said the Congress was cornered across the country over the issue of *Vande Mataram* and people were demanding answers from the party over the "insult to the National Song".

Former Union Minister and BJP MP Ravi Shankar Prasad criticised Mr. Gandhi for staging a dharna without permission. He said the Congress was indulging in "the politics of anarchy to divert attention after being cornered on the issue of *Vande Mataram*".

Cong. view on National Song a very serious issue: Rajnath

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Friday criticised the Congress over its stand on *Vande Mataram*.

The Congress Working Committee, citing its 1937 resolution, had decided to sing only two stanzas (of the total six) of the National Song at party events.

"The Congress formally refusing to respect *Vande Mataram* is extremely unfortunate and, from a constitutional perspective, a very serious matter," Mr. Singh said.

Stating that Parliament is the supreme institution of the country, he said any law passed by it is binding on every individual. "If anyone refuses to abide by it, then certainly their allegiance to the Constitution comes under a cloud of suspicion, and if anyone refuses to respect the National Song, then their patriotism too comes under a question mark," he said.

He said the 1937 CWC resolution was passed by bowing before the "extremist demands of the Muslim League". The country had to suffer its consequences in the form of Partition, he said. "Compromising before extremist elements has always proved disastrous for the country, and today, when the Congress is surrendering to extremist elements in the same manner, it is a sign of a serious threat to the future," Mr. Singh said.

Rahul Gandhi's politics on the streets signals a new Opposition playbook

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

A month after his sudden dharna outside the Prime Minister's residence over students' protests, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi's unannounced protest outside the Parliament Street police station to get an FIR registered on a complaint by young pellet-gun victim Sahil Lochab reveals a new political strategy.

For the second time in a month, the Opposition leader not only caught the authorities by surprise but also his own party colleagues. The element of surprise, combined with direct action and sustained engagement, suggests that Mr. Gandhi is willing to experiment with a new political playbook.

The Congress's escalation came a day after Union Home Minister Amit Shah sharpened his attack on the party over its decision to sing only two stanzas of *Vande Mataram*, describing the move as "anti-national".

Mr. Gandhi, however, sought to shift the political focus from the nationalism debate to the use of pellet guns against protesting students and, crucially, to the role of the Ministry of Home Affairs, which Mr. Shah heads.



Rahul Gandhi

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha appears to be seeking a form of consistency in his political actions

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and party general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal both sought to frame the registration of the FIR as a consequence of Mr. Gandhi's intervention.

"Those shedding crocodile tears over nationalism are, in reality, the biggest enemies of the country's youth!" Mr. Kharge said in a post on X. "Sahil is not alone," he added.

Mr. Venugopal said basic constitutional rights were being granted as "favour" only after massive pressure was applied. "They have bent. They were forced to bend," he said in an online post, claiming that the Delhi Police was compelled to register the FIR after Mr. Gandhi protested for hours demanding action over Mr. Lochab's pellet injuries.

By personally following up on the case and eventually ensuring that the FIR sought by Mr. Lochab was registered, Mr. Gandhi appears to be seeking consistency in his politics and, in the process, addressing a criticism that he is an inconsistent politician.

The street protests also point to a larger political calculation: reaching out to, and attempting to create, a distinct constituency among Gen Z voters – a generation that will form a substantial part of the electorate by the 2029 Lok Sabha election. By some estimates, there could be 370-400 million voters in the 18-29 age group by then.

There is also a subtler message in Mr. Gandhi's decision to repeatedly take his politics to the streets. The Opposition leader has increasingly alleged that institutions have become partisan and that constitutional safeguards are being weakened.

By physically confronting police authorities, he is signalling that institutions should recognise that political power is not permanent and that the political Opposition is entitled to a fair and transparent response.

Finally, Mr. Gandhi is seeking to weave the question of accountability of the Home Ministry into the larger political debate over students' grievances.

PONDICHERRY MUNICIPALITY
PUDUCHERRY

No. 04/PM/EE/DB/2026-27Dated: 21.08.2026

PRESS NOTICE FOR 'e' TENDER

On behalf of the Pondicherry Municipal Council, e-Tenders are invited from the eligible contractors / firms by the Commissioner, Pondicherry Municipality, Puducherry for the work of "Development of White Town in Puducherry under the Challenge Based Destination Development Scheme of Government of India. Sub work: Electrical work components in the Development of White Town, Puducherry," which can be downloaded from the website www.pudutenders.gov.in, only by those contractors who are having valid I-Key and Digital Signature Certificate. The detailed procedure is available in the said tender notice.

i. Availability of NIT from 11.30 A.M. on 28.08.2026 to 4.00 PM on 24.09.2026
Closing time for submission of e-tender at 4.00 P.M on the same day of last date of availability of NIT.

ii. Pre-bid meeting : 08.09.2026 at 4.00 P.M.

iii. Date & Time of opening of tender : 24.09.2026 at 4.30 P.M.

Please contact ICICI Bank for e-payment helpdesk guidance in Phone No. 8939202113.

Please contact e-procurement cell, 3rd floor, Chief Secretariat, e-tender help desk for guidance in phone No.0413-2220225 & 1800 3070 2232 (Toll free)
mail id: support-eproc.pon.nic.in

No. 172/DIP/AD (Press)/ADV/T/2026-27Sd/COMMISSIONER

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INDIAN SPACE RESEARCH ORGANISATION (ISRO)
CONSTRUCTION & MAINTENANCE GROUP
ISRO-TELEMETRY TRACKING & COMMAND NETWORK (ISTRAC)
Plot No.12 & 13, 3rd Main, 2nd Phase, Peenya Industrial Estate, Bengaluru-560 058. Fax:080-28094180,
Ph:080-280804182, 4541

CORRIGENDUM-I Date:21.08.2026

1. On behalf of the President of India, item rate E-Tender is invited from Contractors of appropriate class for the following work.

NIT No.	ISTRAC/CMG/E/CON/E-TN-56/ 2026- 2027 Dated: 23.07.2026
Name of Work	Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Power Fencing System of IDSN Campus, ISTRAC, Byalalu
Estimate cost put to tender	Rs. 132.06 Lakhs
Tender Document details	E-Tender
Period of completion	Eight (08) Months
Period during which the tender document can be downloaded	From 16.00 hrs. on 24.07.2026 to 16.08.2026 till 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 05.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Bid clarifications	From 11.00 hrs. on 25.07.2026 to 17.08.2026 till 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 06.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Last date of reply to Bid clarification	18.08.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 07.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Last date & time of receipt of tenders	19.08.2026 up to 16.00 hrs. Extended up to 08.09.2026 up to 16.00 hrs.
Due date and time of opening of tenders	21.08.2026 after 11.00 hrs. Extended up to 10.09.2026 after 11.00 hrs.
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 2,64,120.00

2. Interested Tenderers may please refer Detailed Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) for eligibility criteria and other details in website: www.isro.gov.in and download the tender documents from www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO.

Sd/- Group Head, CMG

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BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
(Mahadevapura/K R Pura Zone) Bengaluru East City Corporation,
Vengaihna Lake ECO Park, K R Pura, Bangalore -560036

No:SADH(MDP/KRP)TENDER/167/2026-27Date: 21.08.2026

**INVITATION FOR TENDER (IFT)
(Two Cover System)**

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)

The Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture (Mahadevapura/ K R Pura) B.E.C.C. (Referred to as Employer in these documents) invites tenders to Implement in accordance with KPPP rules 2000, from eligible and experienced Person/Agencies /Firms (Referred to as Tenderers in these documents) registered in Labour department for Maintenance of Parks.

(Standard Tender Document KW-3).

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Beautification, landscape, development, with Borewell digging and other civil works in Venghaihna Lake ward No.14 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) : Rs. 2,00,00,000.00, EMD Amount : Rs.3,00,000.00

Calendar of Events : (1) Date of Notification : 21.08.2026
(2) Tender can be downloaded from : 22.08.2026 (3) Last Date for Queries : 22.08.2026 (4) Prebid Meeting : 24.08.2026.
(5) Tender Closing Date : 29.08.2026 (6) Technical bid opening date : 01.09.2026 (7) Financially bid opening date : After Approval of Technical bid.

Sd/- Senior Assistant Director of Horticulture
(Mahadevapura/K R Pura Zone), BECC

Turkiye issues arrest warrant for Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu



Japan protests Russian missile tests off disputed Kuril islands



U.S., South Korea wrap up military drills 6 days earlier than planned



Russian drones kill 14 people at a mall in a central Ukrainian city



Imran Khan shifted back to jail after medical check-up

Sport

NOT SO SOLID

A lot of the points we thought we would finish, we couldn't: Chirag



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

After we lost the first game, they came back a lot more harder in the second. They were playing a solid game. A lot of moments where we thought we would get a point, we didn't; lot of the points we thought we would finish, we couldn't. They were not just retrieving, they were converting it into offence — Chirag Shetty.

TOUGH LOSS

We could've been tighter from our side: Satwik after exit from Worlds



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

They (Wei Keng Liang & Chang Wang) like to play a faster game. They were quite good in the first four shots. Whoever controlled the first four shots were winning. They were everywhere. Wherever we were hitting, they were just playing their game. We could have been tighter from our side — Satwiksairaj Rankireddy.

LAID LOW

World No. 1 Sinner withdraws from US Open with knee injury



FILE PHOTO

World No. 1 Jannik Sinner confirmed on Friday he will not compete in the US Open because of a right knee injury. Sinner had been working hard to recover but realised that he still needs more time, the Italian said in a statement. Sinner had also pulled out of the US Open warm-up tournaments in Cincinnati and Montreal.

INFORMAL OFFER

Hussey could join England as the Test batting coach



FILE PHOTO

Australian great Mike Hussey could face his own country in the Ashes after saying on Friday he was open to joining England as its Test batting coach. Hussey has had an informal approach from England's new red-ball coach Stephen Fleming, the duo having spent 15 years as teammates and coaches at Chennai Super Kings.

Treesa and Gayatri extend dream run, ensure medal

The unseeded duo stuns World No. 4 Jia and Zhang in the quarterfinals to maintain India's proud record of at least one podium finish in each edition since 2011; Wei-Chang too good for Satwik-Chirag

BADMINTON WORLDS

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

When in doubt, attack. Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand stuck to the mantra regardless of the scoreline and reaped the rewards, assuring themselves of a maiden medal at the badminton World championships here on Friday.

Their 16-21, 21-15, 21-13 victory against the Chinese World No. 4 Jia Yifan & Zhang Shuxian in the quarterfinals at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium came in 70 minutes. It was their third big scalp in as many matches after ousting the World No. 17 and World No. 7 pairs earlier.

In the process, the unseeded, unfancied duo also became the first Indian women's pair to do make it to the Worlds semifinals since Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa's historic bronze in 2011. In fact that medal started India's streak of winning at least one medal in every edition since then.

It would also be the only medal for India this time after two-time bronze medallists Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty lost to the World No. 3 Chinese pair of Wei Keng Liang and Chang Wang 21-18, 21-9 in just 35 minutes.

Ranked 39th, Treesa and Gayatri trailed 6-0 in the opening game before fighting back to close the gap to 9-8.

They eventually lost 21-16 but at no point did it look like they were ready



Making it a habit: Gayatri and Treesa produced an upset win for the third successive match. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

to give up.

Gayatri being quick and busy on the net, smashed cross-court winners and constantly set Treesa up for the winners.

The two went from 7-10 to 13-10 in the second game and, with nothing to lose, pushed hard.

They cut down the unforced errors and kept it tight, forcing Yifan, a four time World champion and the reigning Olympic champion, to conceding points and took the match into the decider.

Thereafter it was India all the way. Treesa and Gayatri raced to an 11-5 lead before change of ends and closed out the tie 21-13.

Satwik and Chirag, meanwhile, had their chances in the opening game and even led 18-16

before the opponents reeled off five points to win 21-18. The flat drives targeting the Indians' bodies meant Satwik and Chirag were always cramped for space.

Wei and Chang's lightening quick returns, coupled with retrievals from all over the court made it impossible for Satwik and Chiraj to either lift or fall back on their trademark smashes to get points as the Chinese wrapped up the match in quick time.

The results (quarterfinals):

Men: Victor Lai (Can) bt Rasmus Gemke (Den) 21-19, 21-18; Alex Lanier (Fra) bt Kunlavut Vitidsarn (Tha) 19-21, 21-16, 21-16; Kodai Naraoka (Jpn) bt Anders Antonsen (Den) 21-19, 21-15.

Doubles: Wei Keng Liang & Chang Wang (Chn) bt Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty

21-18, 21-9; Kim Won Ho & Seo Seung Jae (Kor) bt Sze Fei Goh & Nur Izzuddin (Mas) 21-16, 21-16; Aaron Chia & Wooli Yik Soh (Mas) bt Ke Yuan Hu & Xiang Yi Lin (Chn) 21-11, 21-17; Jhe-Huei Lee & Po-Hsuan Yang (Tpe) bt Fajar Alfian & Muhammad Shohibul Fikri (Ina) 21-19, 21-16.

Women: An Se-young (Kor) bt Yue Han (Chn) 21-19, 21-12; Pornpawee Chochuwong (Tha) w/o Nozomi Okuhara (Jpn); Akane Yamaguchi (Jpn) bt Michelle Li (Can) 21-17, 21-10; Wang Zhi Yi (Chn) bt Line Christophersen (Den) 21-10, 21-7.

Doubles: Treesa Jolly & Gayatri Gopichand bt Yi Fan Jia & Shu Xian Zhang (Chn) 16-21, 21-15, 21-13; Baek Ha Na & Lee So Hee (Kor) bt Febriana Dwiiputi Kusuma & Meilysa Trias Puspitasari (Mas) 21-11, 21-11; Sheng Shu Liu & Ning Tan (Chn) bt Nga Ting Yeung & Pui Lam Yeung (Tpe) 21-14, 21-17; Yi Jing Li & Xu Min Luo (Chn) bt Rachel Rose & Febi Setianingrum (Ina) 21-13, 21-14.

We won't stop here: Treesa and Gayatri

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

'Keep calm and carry on,' Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand kept telling each other en route a historic quarterfinal win against Jia Yifan and Shuxian Zhang, who have between them clinched five medals at the World championships and two at the Olympics.

It was forgotten the moment Yifan sent the shuttle wide on match point, Gayatri sprawling on the court and Treesa rushing to hug P. Gopi Chand and B. Sumeeth Reddy in the coaches' corner. They broke down, took a long break before returning to



Ready for more: Gayatri and Treesa. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

answer questions and for once, no one grudged the Indian youngsters.

"It was really difficult with all the emotions and processing what had finally happened but we are ok now," Treesa admitted.

"We are really happy to get into the semifinals and confirm a medal but we are not stopping here. There are matches still to come," she declared.

Next up will be the top-seeded pair of Sheng Shu

Liu and Ning Tan but when asked about the match, Gayatri insisted there would be little change in the mindset.

"We don't want to think too much about the outcome. Today was also a tough match, we knew it would not be easy. We were trailing by a game and even in the second, it was tricky. We told each other to stay calm and will do the same tomorrow, get on court and give our 100 percent and just enjoy," she added.

Gayatri has made no secret of Gopichand the father's strict regimen, but on Friday there were no complaints about Gopichand the coach from either.

A new order in the men's game

Devvanshi Bihani
NEW DELHI

The old order is over and a new order has kicked in. The men's singles semifinal line-up at the World championships has reinforced that.

No one from the world's top-5 made the semifinals here. Instead, Victor Lai of Canada and Alex Lanier of France, the 21-year-olds, will meet in a last-four clash while Taiwan's 36-year-old Chou Tien Chen, who became the oldest medallist in World championships history, faces Japan's Kodai Naraoka in the other.

Lai, already Canada's

first Worlds medallist after last year's breakthrough, is now guaranteed another medal. His quarterfinal against Rasmus Gemke was less about brilliance and more about resilience as he recovered from early deficits in both games. "Each game I play, I learn more," said Victor.

Lanier has already created history. He fought back from 3-11 in the second game to upstage 2023 champion Kunlavut Vitidsarn and became the first Frenchman to win a men's singles medal in the tournament.

"We have the talent and we are also training hard," said Lanier.



Lanier... causing a flutter. AP

The women's draw, on the other hand, offers a mix of familiar names and fresh storylines.

Defending champion An Se-young, returning from a leg injury, stormed into the semifinals without dropping a game. She will meet

Wang Zhiyi, who ended the Korean's 10-match winning streak earlier this season before being beaten by her in the Asian championships final. "The leg is getting better with every match," revealed Se-young.

Akane Yamaguchi won in just 28 minutes against Michelle Li while Thailand's Pornpawee Chochuwong reached her first Worlds semifinal and secured a maiden major medal without playing a shot after Nozomi Okuhara withdrew with a knee injury. "I feel sad more than happy," said Chochuwong, who has endured many injury layoffs herself.

Indian team sweats it out in gruelling conditions

INDIA IN SRI LANKA

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Surrounded by expansive trees and skyscrapers, the Sinhalese Sports Club (SSC) Ground was like a sauna on Friday. A maximum of 30 degree Celsius belied the actual heat felt in the premises and in this cauldron, the Indian team practised as part of the build-up towards the second Test commencing here on Sunday.

K.L. Rahul and Kuldeep Yadav skipped the pre-game drills, and spin-bowling coach Sairaj Bahutule clarified that the duo was resting. The others did their batting and bowling stints while coach Gautam Gambhir and chief selector Ajit Agarkar watched. Yashasvi Jaiswal, Devdutt Padikkal, Rishabh Pant and Shubman Gill consti-



Stretching every sinew: Pant pulls off an acrobatic take during the training session. PTI

tuted the first quartet that batted.

Gill freed his arms and unleashed big shots while the warning 'watch-out' rang aloud through the ground. Later, the skipper had a chat with Gambhir while Ravindra Jadeja, Dhruv Jurel, Sarfaraz Khan and others batted. Off-spinner Saransh Jain turned his arm over and it remains to

be seen if he will come into contention against a left-hander heavy Sri Lankan batting.

Bowling coach Morne Morkel, always busy at nets, ran in and bowled too.

He had mentioned about coping with the heat in Galle, guess the same challenge awaits his wards in the Sri Lankan capital.

Bahutule supports 'match-winner' Kuldeep

K.C. Vijaya Kumar
COLOMBO

Nostalgia may have enveloped Sairaj Bahutule when he entered the Sinhalese Sports Club Ground. He would have remembered his last Test played at the same venue in 2001, a game India lost. The Indian spin-bowling coach, though, quickly immersed himself in the nets here on Friday.

Later, near the dugout, he spoke to the media about the twirly men under his watch. Many questions centred around Kuldeep Yadav, a fine talent but seemingly rusty at the moment. "Kuldeep has been bowling extremely well. It's just that due to the situation that arose in Galle, he had to play a different role. He tried his best to execute that role," Bahutule said.

Getting more technical in his analysis, the Mumbai-kaar added: "We had to see how the trajectory and the speeds work in every



Tough times: Kuldeep struggled in the Galle Test, picking up only one wicket from 25 overs. PTI

session. As the days went by, there was a demand for different types of speeds and trajectories, he definitely was making an effort to bowl that."

Praises Suthar

Turning his eye towards Manav Suthar, Bahutule said: "He is somebody who has bowled a lot in domestic cricket and has done the hard yards. He understands his bowling well.

What we try to do is to see how that awareness of bowling gets better in different conditions, on different pitches, and against different batters. He is very accurate and his trajectories are getting better. He puts in a lot on the ball, the revolutions are good and he is somebody who is like a banker for us."

Bahutule also spoke about the essential nature of ideal preparation: "It's

very difficult for a player sometimes to adjust to different formats. But I think what we did coming early on this tour was, you know in that warm-up game and in the open net sessions, we trained well and got to understand the conditions and could adapt to it. The amount of cricket being played is quite a bit but our job as coaches is to manage their minds and help them adapt."

With Sri Lanka adding more left-handed batters to the squad, the temptation to play off-spinner Saransh Jain is real and Bahutule did not deny that: "There is another day to go before the Test. We will have a look at the pitch and understand what will be the need. Yes, the (left-handed) additions are there in their team. We will definitely consider him (Saransh) once the pitch is completely ready."

The speculation over Kuldeep's berth in the playing XI lingered and when another question was raised, Bahutule said: "He has been a fabulous bowler over the years. Yes, the pitches sometimes are slow and sometimes the ball operates differently for the spinners on certain surfaces. For me, he has always been a match-winner and he definitely is in the scheme of things. But when the ball becomes softer, it becomes even more difficult for a wrist-spinner like him".

Aashin Prasad
AMSTELVEEN

Chance for Indian athletes to fine-tune preparation ahead of Asian Games

England crushes Pakistan

Agence France-Presse
LEEDS

the openers with the new ball, Ollie Robinson got three more wickets, Josh Tongue was introduced after lunch and took three wickets, and Gus Atkinson bowled superbly for the late reward of Pakistan top

Player-of-the-Match: Robinson.

ATHLETICS

Y.B. Sarangi
BHUBANESWAR



Sreeshankar.
SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

SNAPSHOTS

Eyebrows raised as Sreeja figures in the qualifiers

TABLE TENNIS

Amol Karhadkar
KANPUR

Ruling the roost: Vivaan and Divyanshi, winners of the under-17 crowns. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

'Confident Bengaluru will respond to GCL with enthusiasm'

P.K. Ajith Kumar



Dubey. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

A photograph of Lewis Hamilton, a professional racing driver, smiling and holding a trophy. He is wearing a blue racing suit with various sponsor logos including Mercedes, INEOS, and HPE. The background is a blurred blue and white pattern.

Russell. AP

Russell takes sprint pole

FORMULA ONE

Associated Press
ZANDVOORT

Shashi bags a hat-trick as Haryana enters final

JUNIOR HOCKEY

Sports Bureau
PUNE

INBRIEF



Duplantis edges Karalis to win in Lausanne Diamond League

Pole vault world record holder Armand Duplantis edged a gripping battle with his Greek rival Emmanouil Karalis to win the Diamond League competition in Lausanne on Thursday with a jump of 6.21 metres. The double Olympic champion cleared his best mark of the season on his first attempt while Karalis had to settle for 6.16m on his second try. Australian Kurtis Marschall completed the podium with 5.91m.

Spurs agree deal to sign Man City's Savinho: reports

Tottenham has agreed a deal to sign Manchester City winger Savinho for an initial fee of around £75 million, according to reports on Friday. The north London club will pay an extra £10 million in potential add-ons. Tottenham is also interested in signing Savinho's City teammate Omar Marmoush.

LIVE TELECAST

Badminton: World championships, Sports 18-1, 3, JioHotstar & BWF Official YouTube channel, 10.30 a.m.

Hockey World Cup: (Men) SS Select 2, Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 1.30 p.m. 4.30, 6, Netherlands vs India, 7.30 p.m. & 10.30 p.m. (Women): SS Select 2, Star Sports First & JioHotstar, 3 p.m., 6, 9.30 p.m. & 12 a.m. (Sunday)

TNPL: Sony Sports Ten 4 Tamil & TNPL Official YouTube channel (@tamilnadupremierleague.com), 3.30 & 7.30 p.m.

Formula One: Dutch GP (Sprint shootout), F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 3.30 p.m.; Sprint Race: F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 7.30 p.m. Qualifying, 8.30 p.m.

Premier League: SS Select 1 & JioHotstar, 5, 7.30 & 10 p.m.

LaLiga: FanCode, 8.30, 11 p.m. & 1 a.m. (Sunday)

Serie A: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 10.15 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Sunday)

Australia vs Bangladesh: Second Test, Day 2, Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 5.30 a.m. (Sunday)

Barca ready for the Real challenge

LALIGA

Agence France-Presse
BARCELONA

Hansi Flick's second season at Barcelona built on the success of his first, with the German coach guiding the Catalan giant to a second straight LaLiga title. His third campaign, however, brings significant structural change to the team as Barcelona looks to maintain its domestic dominance and handle the threat of Jose Mourinho's Real Madrid while aiming to end its wait for Champions League glory. Barca begins its campaign at Elche on Sunday in the Spanish top flight, a day after Mourinho's Los Blancos visits Espanyol in the Catalan capital.

The arrival of Rodri from Manchester City is Barca's most significant addition while the departures of veteran striker Robert Lewandowski and Ferran Torres leave Flick with a reshaped attacking unit. Barcelona has been prolific going forward but vulnerable at the back since Flick arrived in 2024, and the club hopes the arrival of World Cup winner Rodri can help address the latter.

The Spain captain was a market opportunity Barcelona was reluctant to pass up, particularly with Real also linked with the 30-year-old holding midfielder before his move to Catalonia. He brings the experience of winning the biggest trophies, qualities Barcelona hopes can help it claim a first European crown since 2015.

KARNATAKA ROUND-UP

Azhar claims Kolar Open
BENGALURU: M. Azhar carded a one-under 71 to claim his maiden professional title at the second edition of the ₹1 crore Kolar Open at Zion Hills Golf County at Kolar on Friday. The 27-year-old Hyderabad golfer (70-68-70-71) finished at 279 to secure a two-shot victory. He collected the winner's cheque of ₹15 lakh, and took his season's earnings to ₹35,14,675. Chandigarh's Angad Cheema (73-68-67-73), a four-time winner on the tour, and Delhi's Shaurya Bhattacharya (68-67-71-75), a three-time winner, shared second place at 281.

Tanisha Gowda bags double
Tanisha Gowda claimed a double in the State ranking sub-junior girls' billiards and snooker tournament here. **The results: Finals: Billiards:** Tanisha Gowda bt Niyati Aradhya 77-72. **Snooker:** Tanisha Gowda bt Niyati Aradhya 50-21, 52-17.

Vihitha, Samarth triumph in junior National athletics
Karnataka swimmers Vihitha Nayana (30.64s) and Samarth Gowda (27.81s) won the girls' 50m backstroke and boys' 50m backstroke events, respectively, at the 52nd Junior National aquatics championships in Bhubaneswar.

Varshneya renews contract with BFC
Midfielder Soham Varshneya signed a contract extension with Bengaluru FC, committing



Rewarding a champion: Azhar receiving his trophy and winner's cheque from Amandeep Johl, CEO, DP World PGTI, left, and George Menompampil, managing director of Zion Hills Golf County. PGTI



Reigning supreme: DYES-A emerged victorious in the 10th Hockey Karnataka League Championship. It won 11 out of the 12 matches. Canara Bank and RWF finished second and third, respectively.



Samarth. his future to the club until 2029. Varshneya, 22, featured eight times for



Vihitha. the club during the 2025-26 Indian Super League.



SNAPSHOTS

Aaditya and Jaiveer share the lead

MUMBAI: Aaditya Dhingra and Jaiveer Mahendru shared the lead with three points each at the end of the third round of the Asian junior chess championship here on Friday. **Important results (third round): Open:** V.S. Nandish 2.5 drew with Mayank Chakraborty 2.5; Shageli Kurbandurdyev (Tk) 2.5 drew wit Apoorv Kamble 2.5; Aaditya Dhingra 3 bt Alekhyia Mukhopadhyay 2; Daksh Jagesha 2.5 drew with Guru Prakash 2.5; Jaiveer Mahendru 3 bt Chukka Radha Karthik 2; Manav Kumar 2 lost to Amanmuhammed Hommadev 2.5; Ilan Charyev (Tk) 2.5 bt Imangali Akhilbay (Kaz) 1.5; Madhvendra Sharma 2.5 bt Hardik Shah 1.5; Sanjeeban Mandal 2 drew with Arshpreet Singh 2. **Girls:** Kasthuri Bhai 2 lost to Prattee Bordoloi 3; Mariya Kholiyavko (Kaz) 2.5 drew with Akshaya Sathi 2.5; S. Pranavasri 3 bt Lala Shohradova (Tk) 2; Leyla Shohradova (Tk) 3 bt V. Tripurambika 2; G. Shivambika 3 bt Aditri Shome 2; Sannidhi Bhat 2 drew with Sunetra Dey 2; Prishita Gupta 2.5 bt Aaradhya

Das 1.5; Dakshita Kumawat 2.5 bt Marium Fatima 1.5; Shraddha Bajaj 1.5 lost to V.C. Nivedita 2.5.

Fifty-six entries for National Racing Challenge

CHENNAI: The MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 4W will get underway at the Madras International Circuit here on Saturday with 56 entries across six categories. The opening round will feature the MRF Formula 2000, MRF Formula 1600, Formula LGB 1300, Indian Super Touring, Super Stock, and Volkswagen Polo Cup classes. Singapore's 16-year-old Karen Kaur and former National champion Raghul Rangasamy will be among those competing in the Formula 2000 category. Four-time National title-winner Arjun Narendran and former National Rally champion Karna Kadur will battle it out in the Indian Super Touring Cars class.

THE HINDU TeenDigest
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PUBLIC NOTICE

We are undertaking a title investigation on the immovable property being all that piece and parcel of the converted industrial land bearing Property No. 758/381/Survey No. 31 and E-PID No. 1001640267 (Carved out of Survey No. 31 (old Survey No. 29) of Nagasandra Village), admeasuring 1,58,405 square feet (equivalent to 03 Acres 25.5 Guntas), situated at Nagasandra Village, 8th Mile, Chokkasandra Ward - 39, Yeshwanthpura Hobli, Tumkur Road, Bengaluru North Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District-560 073 together with structure standing thereon (more fully described in the 'Schedule' hereto and hereinafter referred to as 'Schedule Property'). The said title due diligence is being conducted for and on behalf of our Client who is desirous of acquiring by way of sale, the Schedule Property from Tracstar Distilleries Private Limited (having CIN: U15533MH2001PTC132191) (hereinafter referred to as the 'Owner'). The Owner has represented to our Client that it is the absolute owner and in possession of the Schedule Property, with unrestricted rights of alienation over the same.

Notice is hereby given to the general public that any person/s other than the Owner, asserting any right, title, charge, lien, claim/s or any interest whatsoever in respect of the Schedule Property is hereby called upon to submit to the undersigned, their claim/s, if any, over the Schedule Property or submit their objections, if any, to the aforementioned transaction. The said claim/s or objections must be in writing, together with documentary proof to support such claim/s or objections and must be delivered to us at the address given below within a period of **15 (Fifteen) days** from the date of publication of this Notice. If no such claim/s or objections are received within the aforesaid period, it shall be deemed that no person other than the present Owner has any right, title, interest or claim whatsoever in respect of the Schedule Property and our Client would be at liberty to proceed with the proposed transaction in relation thereto without any reference to such claim(s), if any.

SCHEDULE
(Description of the Schedule Property)
All that piece and parcel of the immovable property converted for industrial purposes and bearing Property No. 758/381/Survey No. 31 and E-PID No. 1001640267 (Carved out of Survey No. 31 (old Survey No. 29) of Nagasandra Village), admeasuring 1,58,405 square feet (equivalent to 03 Acres 25.5 Guntas), situated at Nagasandra Village, 8th Mile, Chokkasandra Ward - 39, Yeshwanthpura Hobli, Tumkur Road, Bengaluru North Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District, together with the structure standing thereon. The said property is bounded as follows:
On the East by : Land held by Gemini Distilleries Private Limited;
On the West by : Land held by Gemini Distilleries Private Limited;
On the North by : Bangalore - Tumkur National Highway; and
On the South by : Land held by Gemini Distilleries Private Limited.

Sd/- Mr. Srinivas B.R, Partner
DSK Legal,
Prestige Loka, No. 201, 2nd Floor, No. 7/1 & 7/7, Brunton Road, Date: 22.08.2026
Craig Park Layout, Bengaluru - 560025.Tel: 080-69548770. Place: Bengaluru

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NO. 1A-1295/26 FA-214/18/8-2/586 DATED 29/07/2026

In the matter of:
VIJAY KUMAR
Vs.
OCEAN TRAVELS
1. M/S OCEAN TRAVELS (THROUGH RAVINDER KUMAR AND ANIL KUMAR GUPTA) 1360/10B, GOVINDPURI, KALKAJI, NEW DELHI-110019
ALSO AT: HOUSE NO. 1260/13G, GOVINDPURI, KALKAJI, NEW DELHI-110019

Whereas an appeal/complaint against you has been made to this Commission for adjudication. In compliance of the order dated 18/05/2026, the Appellant/Complainant are hereby directed to effect Substituted service of Summons upon the Respondent/ Opposite Party by way of publication in the newspaper "HINDU (ENGLISH NEWSPAPER)" and "PRAJA VANI (KANNADA NEWSPAPER)" to appear in this Commission in person or by a pleader or an authorized agent duly instructed and able to answer all the material question in relation to the appeal/complaint on 16/09/2026 at 10:30 a.m. sharp.

The Appellant/Complainant is further directed to file an Affidavit stating that the service has been effected on the Respondent/ Opposite Party by way of publication before the next date of hearing.

Given under my hand and the seal of this Commission on this 29.07.2026.

REGISTRAR STATE COMMISSION

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, SIREESH B s/o B Eswara Naidu, Residing at Flat No: B821, Nikhar Aventino Apartment, Doddakannali, Bangalore - 560035. Changed my Name as Sireesh Beemini.

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ನಗರಸಭಾ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಲಯ, ಮಂಡ್ಯ
ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ:ನಸಮಂ/ಕಾಮಗಂ ವಿಭಾಗ/ಟೆಂಡರ್-10/3ನೇ ಕೆ/2026-27
ದಿನಾಂಕ : 20-08-2026

ಇ-ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರ್‌ಮೆಂಟ್ ಮರು ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ

2025-26ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನ ಮಾನ್ಯ ಮುಖ್ಯಮಂತ್ರಿಗಳ ಮೂಲ ಸೌಕರ್ಯ ಅಭಿವೃದ್ಧಿ ಯೋಜನೆ (ಸಿ.ಎಂ.ಎ.ಡಿ.ಒ) ಅನುದಾನದಡಿ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಯನ್ನು ಕೈಗೊಳ್ಳಲು KTTA Act 1999 & 2000ರಂತೆ, ಲೋಕಾರೋಪಣೆಗೆ ಇಲಾಖೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಮತ್ತು ಇ-ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರೆಂಟ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ನೋಂದಾಯಿತ ಅರ್ಹ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರಿಂದ ಇ-ಪ್ರೋಬ್‌ಲ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ನ್ನು KW-4ರ ದಾಸ್ತಾವೇಜು ಮೂಲಕ ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದ್ದು, ಆಸಕ್ತ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆದಾರರು <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ಆನ್‌ಲೈನ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬಹುದಾಗಿದೆ. ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕ : 28.08.2026 ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ 4.30 ಗಂಟೆಯೊಳಗೆ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವುದು. ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ವಿವರವನ್ನು ಕಛೇರಿಯ ಸೂಚನಾ ಫಲಕದಲ್ಲಿ ಮತ್ತು ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್ www.mandyacity.mrc.gov.in ನಲ್ಲಿ ಪಡೆಯಬಹುದು.

ಕ್ರ ಸಂ : 01. ಇಂಡಂಟ್ ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ : DMA/2025-26/RD/WORK_INDENT43005/Call-3. ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ (ರೂ. ಲಕ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ) : 341.39. ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ಗಿಟ್ಟ ಮೊತ್ತ (ರೂ.ಲಕ್ಷಗಳಲ್ಲಿ) : 286.85. ಇ.ಎಂ.ಡಿ ಮೊತ್ತ (ರೂ.ಗಳಲ್ಲಿ) : 4,31,000/-.

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1) No: KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4678 Date: 19.08.2026 for Erection and Dismantling of Cuplock Scaffolding system, Water washing, descaling of furnace and "D" meter survey of boiler tubes/bends along with replacement of eroded tubes/bends of first and second pass of Boiler for Unit#1 500MW of BTPS. **Amount Put To Tender** (Approx Excluding Gst) : Rs.116.05 lakhs. **EMD: Rs.200000/-**. **Period of Contract** : 1 Year extendable by six months. **Last date for submission of bids:** 27.08.2026 Time :10.30 AM. Further details can be had from the office of EE(BM)-1, BTPS, KPCL Kudithini, Bellary Dist. Contact : 9480830331.

2) KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK_INDENT4535 Date: 19.08.2026 for "Annual overhauling works of NDCTs at BTPS". **Amount put to tender** : Rs. 21.06 lakhs, **EMD:** Rs. 50,000. Period of completion : 3 months. Further details can be obtained from office of Executive Engineer (OLAJ)/BTPS, MOB-9141607350.



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Who will seize control of the post-Pep Premier League era?

With Guardiola abdicating the throne and leaving his kingdom after six top-flight English titles in 10 years, there will be an almighty war of succession. The 2026-27 Premier League season will be the battleground to decide whom the power is transferred to

N. Sudarshan

The 10 years Pep Guardiola spent at Manchester City represent one of the greatest acts of dynasty-building in the sporting universe. Not only did the Catalan coach City to six Premier League titles, five League Cups, three FA Cups, one UEFA Champions League crown and one at the FIFA Club World Cup, he did so by assembling multiple great sides, revolutionising tactics, and constantly reinventing himself.

Dominant reign

Guardiola's six Premier League trophies are second only to Alex Ferguson's 13 at Manchester United, and even in the four years when City did not win the top prize, it stayed in the top three. No other coach won more than one Premier League title during Guardiola's time in England. When such a king abdicates the throne and leaves his kingdom, as Guardiola did at the end of the 2025-26 campaign, there is bound to be an almighty jostle among those below to be the immediate heir. The 2026-27 Premier League season, which got underway late on Friday (August 21), will be the battleground to decide whom the power is transferred to. The set-up is conducive for an intriguing competition. City without Guardiola will be one of nine clubs to have new coaches, and two others in Manchester United and Tottenham Hotspur did not have Michael Carrick and Roberto De Zerbi in place at the start of the year. Mikel Arteta, who secured Arsenal its first English top-flight crown in 22 years, is the most experienced, having been in the job for a little over six years and seven months. Unai Emery, who masterminded Aston Villa's 2025-26 Europa League triumph, is next, with a stint now at

Pep assembled multiple great sides, revolutionised tactics, and constantly reinvented himself

roughly three years and 10 months. Though Guardiola has exited the scene, his giant shadow still looms. Enzo Maresca, who has replaced the 55-year-old at the Etihad, and Arteta have served as his assistants. Xabi Alonso, installed as Chelsea's new manager, was once Guardiola's midfield marshal at Bayern Munich. The post-Pep Premier League era will not have a clean break in terms of tactics too, for Guardiola has left a deep imprint, both in terms of the first principles he introduced, and how he evolved and shed his orthodoxies to cater to the League's fast-changing demands. When he first arrived, Guardiola was a cleric of the possession-heavy school and was canonical in his belief that retaining the ball was the best route to success. So much so that even goalkeepers weren't spared; one of his first decisions at City was to replace Joe Hart, a top-class shot-stopper, with Claudio Bravo, a ball-playing goalie. And it felt like the league as a whole – with the glorious exception of Jose Mourinho's Manchester United – was trying to inculcate parts of it. Guardiola then changed tack to embrace high-energy players and those with great individual skills in order to adjust to the breathless, end-to-end football that the likes of Jurgen Klopp (Liverpool) and Mauricio Pochettino (Tottenham) introduced. The controlled aggression of the earlier years made way for a more expressive and expansive style. **Philosophical blasphemy** And in his last four seasons in charge, he played with one of world football's purest strikers in Erling Haaland. For a man who once made Lionel Messi turn out as a False 9, and then won two

Premier League trophies in 2020-21 and 2021-22 with midfielders as top-scorers (Ilkay Gundogan with 13 goals and Kevin de Bruyne 15), to have Haaland score 112 times over four campaigns would have been akin to philosophical blasphemy. However, football is now more direct and physical than in recent times and it is to Guardiola's credit that he tweaked his methods and put in place a blueprint for success. "You need to adapt, evolve," City's Maresca said recently. "Set-pieces, man to man – it's a little bit the direction where football is going. We managers... it's our duty to find solutions." Who among Arteta, Carrick, Alonso, Andoni Iraola and Maresca will answer the call? For one, the sight of Arteta, Carrick and Alonso walking briskly up and down the touchline is sure to remind fans of their glory days as players for Arsenal, Manchester United and Liverpool not so long ago. For a certain generation, it will appear like they are reliving a childhood dream. Arteta has the first-mover advantage, having already won the League and possessing a winning combination. The addition of Bruno Guimaraes from Newcastle for GBP 75 million will reduce the inordinate burden on midfielder Declan Rice. But Arsenal's unsuccessful pursuit of Vinicius Junior suggests that the outfit is mindful of the need of a world-class threat upfront. Carrick, who took over at Old Trafford after the sacking of Ruben Amorim, had an impressive stint as caretaker manager, winning 12 and drawing three of his 17 matches in 2025-26, and helping United qualify for the Champions League after a two-season hiatus. The question before the astute 45-year-old is whether his United has the quality to sustain simultaneous domestic and continental challenges. For Alonso, Chelsea is the opportunity to light up an aura that has seemingly dimmed after a failed seven-month stint as Real Madrid's boss. The 44-year-old is known to possess a shrewd tactical brain, and his role in ending Bayern Munich's hegemony in Germany – 11 straight Bundesliga titles from 2012-13 to 2022-23 – by leading a young Bayer Leverkusen side to

The ground is fertile for competition. Who among Arteta, Carrick, Alonso, Iraola and Maresca will answer the call? its maiden crown is noteworthy. The addition of 24-year-old English attacking midfielder Morgan Rogers for a whopping GBP 117 million shows that he has Chelsea's wholehearted trust. Andoni Iraola's ascent to the top job at Liverpool after making a mark at Bournemouth is eerily similar to Graham Potter's entry into Chelsea in 2022 after a stellar show at Brighton & Hove Albion. But Potter was dismissed in less than seven months, a fate Iraola will want to avoid. The 44-year-old is agnostic to any style of play that is not front-footed, a factor that endeared him to the Liverpool hierarchy after a dreary end to Arne Slot's time. Can he manage to keep the club faithful happy without the services of Mohamed Salah, who left after nine glorious years?

Tough act to follow Maresca's situation at City is comparable to what David Moyes faced at United after the latter succeeded Ferguson in 2013. The Italian's first test will be to not get crushed under the burden of expectations after Guardiola's supremely successful tenure. It helps that City is not known to be trigger-happy, for both Roberto Mancini and Manuel Pellegrini enjoyed tenures lasting three years or more before Guardiola arrived. Maresca also comes with a certain pedigree, having led Chelsea to FIFA Club World Cup glory in 2025, and has added England midfielder Elliot Anderson for a hefty GBP 116 million fee. But he will have to compete without the talismanic World Cup winner Rodri, who has shifted to Barcelona, and fellow playmaker Bernardo Silva, who has moved to Real Madrid. Will he be guided by the spirit of Guardiola or will the ghost of Guardiola haunt him?



STACKING UP



ATP Men's Top 15

#	Player	Age	Points	Events
1	Jannik Sinner	24	13,450	17
2	Carlos Alcaraz	23	8,160	17
3	Alexander Zverev	29	8,090	20
4	Felix Auger-Aliassime	26	4,740	22
5	Novak Djokovic	39	3,760	16
6	Ben Shelton	23	3,670	22
7	Daniil Medvedev	30	3,580	23
8	Alex de Minaur	27	3,560	24
9	Taylor Fritz	28	3,375	22
10	Flavio Cobolli	24	3,330	26
11	Rafael Jodar	19	2,621	24
12	Learner Tien	20	2,545	22
13	Alexander Bublik	29	2,525	26
14	Jiri Lehecka	24	2,470	21
15	Lorenzo Musetti	24	2,415	22

Top Indians ▶



Sumit Nagal
Rank 239 ▼ 4 spots



Manas Dhamne
Rank 368 ▼ 6 spots



F1 Drivers' standings

#	Driver	Team	Points	Wins
1	A.K. Antonelli	Mercedes	219	6
2	L. Hamilton	Ferrari	169	1
3	G. Russell	Mercedes	160	2
4	C. Leclerc	Ferrari	138	1
5	L. Norris	McLaren	128	1
6	M. Verstappen	Red Bull	109	0
7	O. Piastri	McLaren	92	0
8	I. Hadjar	Red Bull	68	0
9	L. Lawson	RB	43	0
10	P. Gasly	Alpine	42	0
11	A. Lindblad	RB	23	0
12	F. Colapinto	Alpine	19	0
13	O. Bearman	Haas	18	0
14	G. Bortoleto	Audi	10	0
15	C. Sainz	Williams	6	0
16	A. Albon	Williams	5	0
17	E. Ocon	Haas	3	0
18	N. Hulkenberg	Audi	2	0
19	F. Alonso	Aston Martin	1	0
20	V. Bottas	Cadillac	0	0
21	S. Perez	Cadillac	0	0
22	L. Stroll	Aston Martin	0	0



A.K. Antonelli



L. Hamilton

F1 Constructors' standings

Pos	Team	Points	Wins
1	Mercedes	379	8
2	Ferrari	307	2
3	McLaren	220	1
4	Red Bull	177	0
5	RB	66	0
6	Alpine	61	0
7	Haas	21	0
8	Audi	12	0
9	Williams	11	0
10	Aston Martin	1	0
11	Cadillac	0	0



Badminton Men's ranking

#	Player	Points	Events
1	Shi Yu Qi	94,255	12
2	Kunlavut Vitidsarn	91,215	16
3	Jonatan Christie	89,231	17
4	Anders Antonsen	87,705	17
5	Christo Popov	87,002	20
6	Chou Tien Chen	84,280	27
7	Victor Lai	76,465	19
8	Lin Chun-Yi	71,274	19
9	Li Shi Feng	70,483	16
10	Alex Lanier	70,215	16
11	Kodai Naraoka	70,030	20
12	Alwi Farhan	69,419	19
13	Loh Kean Yew	66,300	20
14	Lakshya Sen	65,573	21
15	Toma Junior Popov	62,697	20

Top Indians ▶



Lakshya Sen
Rank 14



Ayush Shetty
Rank 22

Badminton Women's ranking

#	Player	Points	Events
1	An Se Young	1,17,787	15
2	Akane Yamaguchi	1,04,576	18
3	Wang Zhi Yi	1,02,689	16
4	Chen Yu Fei	91,451	15
5	Han Yue	77,038	14
6	Putri Kusuma Wardani	76,473	18
7	Ratchanon Intanon	74,606	20
8	Tomoka Miyazaki	68,106	22
9	P.V. Sindhu	67,601	14
10	Pornpawee Chochuwong	66,727	16
11	Nozomi Okuhara	60,310	17
12	Kim Ga Eun	59,731	16
13	Michelle Li	55,227	21
14	Sim Yu Jin	55,084	10
15	Line Christophersen	54,060	21

Top Indians ▶



P.V. Sindhu
Rank 9



Unnati Hooda
Rank 26



Test Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Harry Brook	852	898
2	Joe Root	840	932
3	Steve Smith	833	947
4	Travis Head	819	884
5	Temba Bavuma	775	806
6	Kamindu Mendis	744	784
7	Shubman Gill	743	807
8	Rachin Ravindra	740	740
9	Yashasvi Jaiswal	733	858
10	Babar Azam	716	882

ODI Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Shubman Gill	801	841
2	Daryl Mitchell	794	840
3	Virat Kohli	767	908
4	Rohit Sharma	758	879
5	Ibrahim Zadran	719	756
6	Babar Azam	689	894
7	Joe Root	674	810
8	Shai Hope	673	782
9	Charith Asalanka	659	705
10	Harry Tector	653	730

T20I Batting

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Ishan Kishan	910	910
2	Sahibzada Farhan	848	848
3	Abhishek Sharma	819	931
4	Phil Salt	799	881
5	Pathum Nissanka	751	796
6	Tilak Varma	750	845
7	Jos Buttler	748	794
8	Harry Brook	734	734
9	Mitchell Marsh	706	706
10	Dewald Brevis	702	738

Test Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Jasprit Bumrah	870	908
2	Matt Henry	861	870
3	Mitchell Starc	826	852
4	Marco Jansen	825	825
5	Pat Cummins	818	914
6	Scott Boland	820	820
7	Kagiso Rabada	807	902
8	Noman Ali	800	853
9	Josh Hazlewood	795	864
10	Gus Atkinson	729	766

ODI Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	714	775
2	Abrar Ahmed	675	675
3	Jofra Archer	649	682
4	Keshav Maharaj	645	737
5	Mitchell Santner	644	656
6	Maheesh Theekshana	641	680
7	Adil Rashid	613	631
8	Shaheen Afridi	604	691
9	Mehidy Hasan	602	722
10	Adil Rashid	599	671

T20I Bowling

#	Player	Rating	Career best
1	Rashid Khan	753	828
2	Abrar Ahmed	736	757
3	Adil Rashid	710	747
4	Adam Zampa	700	746
5	Nathan Ellis	675	678
6	Corbin Bosch	669	745
7	Wanindu Hasaranga	668	809
8	Mujeeb Ur Rahman	663	757
8	Varun Chakravarthy	663	818
10	Mohammad Nawaz	658	672



KIMI ANTONELLI

Abnormal service resumes: the 2026 F1 season rolls on

Antonelli's emergence, Hamilton's new lease of life, Russell's burden of expectations, Verstappen's displeasure — a hotly debated set of disruptive regulations has led to a curious first half of 2026. How will these storylines play out after the mid-season break?

S. Dipak Ragav

The 2026 season of Formula One ushered in some of the most drastic regulatory changes in the sport's history. As teams and drivers still try to get around the new cars, the year's first half has been a mixed bag for on-track action. Nonetheless, there has been enough to keep the fans interested. With the F1 carnival reconvening after the summer break in Zandvoort this weekend, *The Hindu* reviews the major themes so far to see what could lie ahead.

Energy-starved cars

The new rules, which brought hybrid power units closer to a 50-50 split between the internal combustion engine and the electric motor, raised concerns at the outset that the cars would be energy-starved. When pre-season testing began, four-time champion Max Verstappen was scathing in his criticism. The battery's limitations meant drivers had to ease off through fast corners to maximise electric power on straights, where time could be gained.

Add to it the complex algorithms governing how the battery deploys and harvests energy, and drivers were forced to adapt their driving styles to the car's limitations. In the first few races, this led to cars being passed and then passing back as the battery pack emptied and recharged, resulting in 'yo-yo racing'. The fans were none the wiser, as one couldn't ascertain whether the moves were genuine. It took time for teams to adapt, and a rule tweak in Miami has also helped reduce some of the worst effects of 'yo-yo racing'. Still, on energy-hun-

The sight of F1 cars unwilling to be driven in anger around fast corners has dampened the spectacle



GEORGE RUSSELL AND LEWIS HAMILTON

gry tracks, the sight of F1 cars unwilling to be driven in anger around fast corners has dampened the spectacle.

Breakout star

One of the great joys of watching elite sport is to marvel at the ability of a wonderkid ruffling the feathers of the established order. Even as F1 has been besieged by negativity around the new regulations, the one bright light has been Kimi Antonelli. The Italian, who will graduate out of his teens on Tuesday (August 25), has taken the F1 world by storm in his sophomore campaign, winning six of the 11 races and leading the championship by 50 points.

The Mercedes driver has taken a clear step up from his error-strewn rookie year, stringing together five consecutive wins at one stage. His aggressive driving style, with sharp steering inputs, seems to work well with the current cars, and the youngster has made full use of the class-leading Mercedes to build a comfortable lead. Team boss Toto Wolff's decision to throw him in the deep end last year appears a stroke of genius.

While Antonelli has a healthy lead, he has already experienced how fickle it can be. He was once 66 points ahead and saw that whittled down to 25 before he built it back up. With a possible 12 races left this year, it is too early to pop the champagne. However, if he keeps doing what he has been doing, keeping a calm head, he could etch his name into the history books.

Plight of the presumptive favourite

George Russell bided his time in an uncompetitive Williams for three years before earning a promotion to Mercedes in 2022 to partner Lewis Hamilton. Unfortunately, it came at a time when the German marque, which had won eight successive titles, messed up the 2022 ground-effect regulations. He was saddled with a car that could at best fight for the occasional win. But in his three years alongside Hamilton, Russell showed he could go toe-to-toe with one of the greatest drivers in history. By the end of 2024, he was faster.

So when he won the first race in Australia from pole and then dominated the sprint in China, he would have felt that his patience was finally paying



MAX VERSTAPPEN

off. Yet, it has pretty much been downhill since then. A mixture of reliability issues, bad luck during races, and his driving style not suiting the current car has left the presumptive pre-season favourite 59 points off top spot.

We will soon know whether Russell has found a way during the summer break to address the pace deficit to his colleague. The title fight could still be between the Mercedes drivers; they have the best package. But the last few races have shown that Ferrari and McLaren are not far off. It is an extra set of variables that the 28-year-old could have done without.

Hamilton's revival

Even as Russell has endured a torrid time, his former teammate has found a new lease of life after four years of struggle in ground-effect cars. Hamilton's initiation into Ferrari was tumultuous, and there were times last year when one wondered if the seven-time champion was past his best. In fact, the Briton himself pondered if he was the right man for the job. However, the nimble 2026 cars seem to have rekindled his mojo and the 41-year-old is now second in the standings.

His hard work at the factory has helped him build a better relationship with the team, which was far from smooth last year. More importantly, the team has also given in to some of his demands, especially regarding the brakes, allowing him to use his preferred Carbone Industrie discs even though Ferrari has a long-standing relationship with rival Brembo. Hamilton's better feel for the brakes has allowed him to exploit the car better, and the result was his first win for Ferrari in Barcelona.

While the title challenge is still a long shot, Hamilton will feel that if he can get good results in the next few rounds, the pursuit of that elusive eighth crown will start to become more real.

Max's Red Bull situation

Verstappen and Red Bull have long maintained that the new-era cars aren't fun to drive. They have also spoken extensively about the limitations of the power unit. While some called it fearmongering, given that Red Bull was building its own engines for the first time, reality has, to an extent, caught up with what they were warning about.

Although Red Bull has done a tremendous job on the powertrains, its electric component is not as strong as Mercedes'. Combine that with a lack of aerodynamic stability and a faulty rear wing, and it's no surprise that Verstappen is far from happy with his team. This led to rumours that the Dutchman was trying to leave Red Bull or even walk away from the sport.

But, on the eve of this weekend's Dutch GP, Verstappen extended his contract up to 2030, showing a commitment to the project under Laurent Mekies, who took over from Christian Horner last year. The Red Bull boss has done a good job of ensuring the team's biggest asset stays.

However, there is now adwdwd pressure on him and the engineers to repay Verstappen's faith and provide the 28-year-old with a car worthy of his generational talent.

GAME THEORY

Mix & match: mixed doubles at the Majors

The second edition of the US Open's radical mixed doubles scheme gets underway next week. The revamp, which came into force last year, was controversial: the main points of criticism were that it prioritised high-profile singles players and devalued the title because of the shortened match format and the exclusion of several doubles specialists. Sara Errani and Andrea Vavassori struck a blow for the traditionalists by winning it; they now have four Major mixed doubles titles together. With the continuing conversation around the event, it's an opportune moment to look at the players and teams with the most success in Grand Slam mixed doubles.



Margaret Court



Doris Hart



Owen Davidson



Billie Jean King

MOST GRAND SLAM MIXED DOUBLES TITLES (BY PLAYER)

Player	Australian Open	French Open	Wimbledon	US Open	Span	Titles
Margaret Court	4	4	5	8	1961–1975	21
Doris Hart	2	3	5	5	1949–1955	15
Owen Davidson	2	1	4	4	1965–1974	11
Billie Jean King	1	2	4	4	1967–1976	11
Margaret Osborne duPont	0	0	1	9	1943–1962	10
Ken Fletcher	2	3	4	1	1953–1968	10
Martina Navratilova	1	2	4	3	1974–2006	10
Leander Paes	3	1	4	2	1999–2016	10

MOST GRAND SLAM MIXED DOUBLES TITLES (BY TEAM)

Player	Australian Open	French Open	Wimbledon	US Open	Span	Titles
Margaret Court & Ken Fletcher	2	3	4	1	1963–1968	10
Doris Hart & Frank Sedgman	2	2	2	2	1949–1952	8
Billie Jean King & Owen Davidson	0	1	4	3	1967–1974	8
Doris Hart & Vic Seixas	0	1	3	3	1953–1955	7
Margaret Court & Marty Riessen	1	1	1	3	1969–1975	6

PICTURE THIS



Giddy-up!

The Duhner Wattrennen is a niche horse race held on the tidal mud flats of the North Sea in Duhnen, a seaside resort in the district of Cuxhaven, Germany.

First run in 1902, the annual event is strictly timed — held in

July or August when the sea-floor is exposed by the ebbing tides.

Duhnen, located about 351 kilometres northwest of Berlin, was at one time a remote fishing and farming village.

But it has grown into one of the tourist centres of Cuxhaven, helped in no small part by the

horse racing, which draws crowds of more than 30,000. The event is accompanied by live bands and other entertainment programmes, adding to the festive atmosphere.

The wet sand, which is softer under-hoof than turf, is said to reduce the impact on a horse's tendons and joints.

This photograph from Duhnen features the harness format, in which horses run with a specific gait (a trot or a pace), pulling a light two-wheeled cart equipped with bicycle wheels.

The cart is called a sulky, because — anecdotally — it once was the choice of unsociable people prone to fits of sulking.